

Current Affairs MCQs PDF - February, 2026



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1. The Zapotec civilization, that was recently seen in news, primarily flourished in which country?

- [A] Mexico
- [B] New Zealand
- [C] Indonesia
- [D] Malaysia

Answer: Mexico

Archaeologists in Mexico found a 1,400-year-old tomb of the Zapotec culture with an owl sculpture holding a man, colorful murals, and calendar carvings. The Zapotec civilization lived in the Valley of Oaxaca, Mexico, using irrigation from the Atoyac River. They shifted from hunting to farming and developed weaving, pottery, and stone building skills. By 200 Before Common Era to 100 Common Era, they formed a centralized state with Monte Albán as capital. Society had nobles, commoners, priests, rituals, human sacrifice, writing, and calendars. Decline began around 900 Common Era, but Zapotec culture still survives today.

2. Recently, the Indian Army and the Indo-Tibetan Border Police conducted Exercise Agni Pariksha in which state?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Manipur
- [C] Nagaland
- [D] Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: Arunachal Pradesh

The Indian Army and the Indo-Tibetan Border Police conducted Exercise Agni Pariksha in Arunachal Pradesh. It was a joint training exercise to improve coordination and combat teamwork between the two forces. This was the first exercise of its kind focusing on inter-force operational integration. Personnel from Spear Corps, artillery regiments, infantry battalions, and the Indo-Tibetan Border Police took part. Non-artillery soldiers were trained in artillery procedures and firing missions.

3. The traditional practice known as Paathara (or Khoni) is primarily related to which activity?

- [A] Community-based rainwater harvesting
- [B] Underground storage of agricultural produce
- [C] Shifting cultivation in hilly terrains
- [D] Preservation of forest produce using natural methods

Answer: Underground storage of agricultural produce

Paathara practice, also called Khoni, is an ancient method of storing grains in underground pits. It was followed by farmers along the Mahendratana River in the



Uddanam region of Srikakulam district near the Andhra Pradesh–Odisha border. Freshly harvested paddy was stored in rectangular pits plastered with straw and clay. The pit was sealed with cow dung to protect grains from moisture, rodents, and theft. Paathara was built in front of thatched houses and supported joint family food security. The tradition is declining due to lack of space, awareness, and changing rural housing styles.

4. The PM-POSHAN Scheme, recently in news regarding honorarium hikes for cooks and helpers, is implemented by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- [B] Ministry of Women and Child Development
- [C] Ministry of Rural Development
- [D] Ministry of Education

Answer: Ministry of Education

22 states and Union Territories have requested the Centre to increase honorarium for cooks and helpers under the PM-POSHAN scheme. PM-POSHAN, formerly Mid-Day Meal Scheme, is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme run by the Ministry of Education. It provides one hot cooked meal per school day to children in Balvatikas (pre-primary) and Classes 1 to 8 in government and government-aided schools.

5. The Bihar government recently approved the installation of the first Grain ATM machines in which city as a pilot project?

- [A] Gaya
- [B] Muzaffarpur
- [C] Bhagalpur
- [D] Patna

Answer: Patna

Bihar approved the first three grain ATM machines in Patna as a pilot project. Grain ATM, also called Annapurti, is an automated machine dispensing wheat or rice. The technology was developed by the World Food Programme in collaboration with the Food Corporation of India and state governments. Machines operate 24×7 and can be solar-powered. They use internet connectivity to access the Public Distribution System database and the profile of Below Poverty Line cardholders.

6. Chhari-Dhand Wetland, which was recently added to the Ramsar network, is located in which state?

- [A] Uttar Pradesh
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Odisha
- [D] West Bengal

Answer: Gujarat

India added two new wetlands to its Ramsar network ahead of World Wetlands Day. Patna Bird Sanctuary in Uttar Pradesh has freshwater marshes, woodlands, and grasslands, supporting high biodiversity. It is designated an Important Bird and Biodiversity Area by BirdLife International. Chhari-Dhand Wetland in Kutch, Gujarat, is a seasonal saline



wetland between Banni grasslands and salt flats.

7. Which state won the national award for Most Proactive State under the Regional Connectivity Scheme (RCS)–UDAN in the Non-Priority Area category?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Madhya Pradesh

Answer: Uttar Pradesh

Uttar Pradesh won the national award for Most Proactive State under the Regional Connectivity Scheme (RCS)–UDAN in the Non-Priority Area category. The award recognises states that are neither hill states nor in the North-East, highlighting UP's aviation expansion under CM Yogi Adityanath. Air passenger numbers grew from 59.97 lakh in 2016 to 1.28 crore in 2024 and 1.55 crore in 2025. Air cargo volume increased from 5,895 metric tonnes in 2016 to 29,761 metric tonnes in 2025, a CAGR of 17.58% over nine years.

8. World Wetlands Day is celebrated every year on which day?

- [A] February 1
- [B] February 2
- [C] February 3
- [D] February 4

Answer: February 2

World Wetlands Day is celebrated every year on 2 February. It marks the adoption of the Convention on Wetlands on 2 February 1971 in Ramsar, Iran, on the Caspian Sea. The 2026 theme is "Wetlands and traditional knowledge: Celebrating cultural heritage." The theme emphasizes the role of indigenous and local knowledge in protecting wetlands. It highlights the importance of wetlands in preserving cultural identity and guiding conservation and management practices.

9. Which Indian city is the host of 39th India International Leather Fair?

- [A] Mumbai
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Kolkata

Answer: Chennai

The 39th India International Leather Fair was held on 1 February in Chennai as a three-day event. It showcased leather products, accessories, machinery, equipment, and latest innovations. The fair highlighted advanced technologies like Artificial Intelligence, additive manufacturing, data analytics, software, and augmented reality. It gained importance after the India–Europe Free Trade Agreement boosting leather trade and investment. India's leather exports were about 4.83 billion US dollars last year. Tamil Nadu and Kerala contribute 38 percent of output and over 45 percent of exports.

10. What is the name of the new platform announced for women entrepreneurs in the Union Budget 2026-27?



- [A] Udyogini Bazaar
- [B] Mahila Haat Plus
- [C] SHE-Mart
- [D] Sakhi Trade Hub

Answer: SHE-Mart

The Finance Minister announced SHE-Mart to support women entrepreneurs through a new market platform. SHE stands for Self-help Entrepreneur, and these marts will be community-owned retail outlets. They will be set up within cluster-level federations using innovative and enhanced financing tools. The aim is to give women better market access, branding support, and stable income. It will strengthen grassroots institutions like Self-Help Groups (SHGs). The initiative builds on the success of the Lakhpati Didi programme.

11. What is the primary objective of the Mahatma Gandhi Gram Swaraj Initiative (MGSI) announced in Union Budget 2026–27?

- [A] Expansion of MSME credit in urban areas
- [B] Promotion of digital startups in rural India
- [C] Modernization of food processing industries
- [D] Strengthening khadi, handloom, and handicrafts

Answer: Strengthening khadi, handloom, and handicrafts

Union Budget 2026–27 announced the Mahatma Gandhi Gram Swaraj Initiative to strengthen traditional rural industries. It focuses on khadi, handloom, and handicrafts sectors across India. The initiative aims to improve global market access, branding, and strong market linkages. It seeks to make traditional industries more competitive and economically sustainable. The programme ensures stable livelihoods for artisans and weavers. It targets weavers, village industries, rural youth, and beneficiaries of One District One Product (ODOP).

12. Which two schemes were announced by the Union Finance Minister in the Union Budget 2026–27 for persons with disabilities?

- [A] Sugamya Bharat Yojana and PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana
- [B] PM Daksh Yojana and Samarth Scheme
- [C] Divyangjan Kaushal Yojana and Divyang Sahara Yojana
- [D] Skill India and Accessible India Campaign

Answer: Divyangjan Kaushal Yojana and Divyang Sahara Yojana

The Union Finance Minister announced Divyangjan Kaushal Yojana and Divyang Sahara Yojana for persons with disabilities in the Union Budget 2026–27. Divyangjan Kaushal Yojana aims to provide dignified livelihood opportunities through skill training. It offers industry-relevant and customised training for different Divyang groups. Divyang Sahara Yojana supports Artificial Limbs Manufacturing Corporation of India (ALIMCO) to expand assistive device production. It promotes research, advanced technology, and artificial intelligence-based solutions.

13. Which Indian state has emerged as the largest contributor to India's renewable energy capacity as of December 2025?



- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Rajasthan
- [C] Haryana
- [D] Uttar Pradesh

Answer: Gujarat

Gujarat leads India's renewable energy sector with 42.583 gigawatt installed capacity, contributing 16.50 percent of the national total as of December 2025. The state ranks first in total renewable and wind power capacity and second in solar power capacity. Renewable energy includes 14,820.94 megawatt wind power and 25,529.40 megawatt solar power, with hybrid and off-grid sources. Gujarat accounts for over 25 percent of India's rooftop solar installations with 6,412.80 megawatt capacity. Major solar parks operate at Charanka, Radhanesda, and Dholera, while Khavda hosts the world's largest renewable park under development.

14. Which country is the host of Global Big Cat Summit 2026?

- [A] Russia
- [B] Nepal
- [C] India
- [D] Bhutan

Answer: India

India will host the first Global Big Cat Summit this year. Leaders and ministers from 95 big cat range countries will participate. The summit will focus on collective and coordinated strategies for big cat conservation. It aims to strengthen international cooperation and protect natural habitats. The initiative will promote sustainable wildlife tourism and habitat protection. India plays a leading role as it has the world's largest wild tiger population.

15. Which initiative was launched in Union Budget 2026–27 to develop India into a global biopharmaceutical manufacturing hub?

- [A] Biopharma SHAKTI
- [B] Make in India–Pharma
- [C] Pharma Vision 2030
- [D] Pharma Vision 2030

Answer: Biopharma SHAKTI

The Union Finance Minister announced the Biopharma SHAKTI initiative in the Union Budget 2026–27 initiative to strengthen India's biopharmaceutical sector. Biopharma SHAKTI stands for Strategy for Healthcare Advancement through Knowledge, Technology and Innovation. It aims to make India a global hub for biopharmaceutical manufacturing. The initiative will support domestic production of biologics and biosimilars. It will build a biopharma-focused network with three new National Institutes of Pharmaceutical Education and Research (NIPER).

16. Which team won the Pro Wrestling League (PWL) 2026 title?

- [A] Delhi Dangal Warriors



- [B] Punjab Royals
- [C] Haryana Thunders
- [D] Mumbai Maharathi

Answer: Haryana Thunders

Haryana Thunders won the Pro Wrestling League (PWL) 2026 title after defeating Delhi Dangal Warriors 5-4 in a thrilling final at Noida Indoor Stadium. Scores were tied 4-4 after eight bouts; the final women's 62kg match decided the championship. Paris Olympic silver medallist Iryna Koliadenko secured technical superiority to clinch victory for Haryana Thunders.

17. Which tennis player won the Australian Open men's singles title 2026?

- [A] Carlos Alcaraz
- [B] Novak Djokovic
- [C] Jannik Sinner
- [D] Alexander Zverev

Answer: Carlos Alcaraz

Carlos Alcaraz won the Australian Open men's singles tennis title 2026, completing his career Grand Slam. He defeated Novak Djokovic 2-6, 6-2, 6-3, 7-5 in the final at Rod Laver Arena. This is Alcaraz's first Australian Open win at the age of 22. Novak Djokovic, 38, was aiming for a record 25th major and to become the oldest man in the Open era to win a Grand Slam. Djokovic was defeated in the Australian Open final for the first time in his 11 appearances.

18. The Cities of Care Conference was inaugurated at which Indian institute in February 2026?

- [A] IIT Madras
- [B] IIT Bombay
- [C] IIT Kanpur
- [D] IIT Ahmedabad

Answer: IIT Madras

The Cities of Care Conference was inaugurated at IIT Madras Research Park by the University of Toronto India Foundation (UTIF), IIT Madras School of Sustainability, and University of Toronto School of Cities. The conference brings together global universities, research institutions, policymakers, and practitioners to advance climate action and sustainable urban development in India. The Sustainable India 2025 report, released during the conference with REVOLVE, highlights India's progress and challenges in energy transition, waste management, urban resilience, and decarbonising industries.

19. SVAMITVA (Survey of Villages Abadi and Mapping with Improved Technology in Village Areas) Scheme is an initiative of which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- [B] Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas
- [C] Ministry of New and Renewable Energy
- [D] Ministry of Panchayati Raj

Answer: Ministry of Panchayati Raj



As of 29 January 2026, under the SVAMITVA Scheme, 3.06 crore property cards have been prepared across 1.86 lakh villages in India. SVAMITVA (Survey of Villages Abadi and Mapping with Improvised Technology in Village Areas) Scheme was launched on 24 April 2020. It is a Central Sector Scheme under the Ministry of Panchayati Raj. The scheme provides legal ownership records to rural property owners via Property Cards. It uses drone surveys and GIS tools for accurate land demarcation, reducing disputes.

20. Which institution organized AIM SUMVAAD, the annual incubator conclave?

- [A] Department of Biotechnology (DBT)
- [B] Reserve Bank of India
- [C] NITI Aayog
- [D] Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Answer: NITI Aayog

Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), under NITI Aayog, organised AIM SUMVAAD, its annual incubator conclave, at Dr Ambedkar International Centre, New Delhi. The event brought together over 100 Atal Incubation Centres (AICs), Atal Community Innovation Centres (ACICs), policymakers, industry leaders, investors, entrepreneurs, mentors, and ecosystem stakeholders. AIM has nearly 50,000 Atal Tinkering Labs and supports over 2 lakh startups, generating 21,000+ jobs. The conclave highlighted incubators as strategic institutions for startup scale-up, technology commercialisation, and entrepreneurship, including deep-tech and AI-driven innovation.

21. Which state achieved top ranks in the Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI) 2.0?

- [A] Tripura
- [B] Assam
- [C] Manipur
- [D] Nagaland

Answer: Tripura

Tripura has achieved top ranks in the Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI) 2.0, highlighting excellence in its Panchayati Raj system. Three Tripura Panchayats among the top four reflect strong grassroots governance and efficiency in the state. The recognition sets a benchmark for rural development, inclusive governance, and public service delivery in Tripura. It reinforces Tripura's reputation as a model state in decentralized governance and village-level administration.

22. Which Indian-origin scientist won the Crafoord Prize, called the "Nobel of Geosciences"?

- [A] Veerabhadran Ramanathan
- [B] Nikku Madhusudhan
- [C] Vandit Verma
- [D] Hargovind Khorana

Answer: Veerabhadran Ramanathan

Veerabhadran Ramanathan, an 81-year-old Indian-origin scientist, won the Crafoord Prize, called the "Nobel of Geosciences," for his pioneering climate research. He grew up in southern India, studied engineering in Bengaluru, and moved to the United States for



higher studies. Early work at a refrigeration company led him to study chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs) and their heat-trapping effect on the atmosphere. In 1975, his Science paper showed that a single CFC molecule could warm the planet as much as thousands of carbon dioxide molecules. His work contributed to the 1987 Montreal Protocol, banning CFCs and preventing further warming.

23. Which state government launched Pilloo AI, a voice-based billing and accounting assistant for businesses?

- [A] Andhra Pradesh
- [B] Kerala
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu launched Pilloo AI, a voice-based billing and accounting assistant for businesses. The app allows users to create invoices, record transactions, generate reports, and manage accounts by speaking in their native language. No prior accounting knowledge or complex software is required, saving time and reducing manual effort. Pilloo AI supports five Indian languages and can record daily sales and payments, generate balance sheets, receivables, and payables. It automates purchase and bank transaction entries by extracting data from uploaded bills and bank statements.

24. Who became the youngest Asian squash player to enter the World Top 20 in Professional Squash Association (PSA) rankings?

- [A] Dipika Pallikal
- [B] Anahat Singh
- [C] Tanvi Khanna
- [D] Urwashi Joshi

Answer: Anahat Singh

Indian teenage squash player Anahat Singh became the youngest Asian to enter the PSA World Top 20, breaking Nicol David's record. She achieved this after winning her first PSA Bronze-level title at the Washington Fire Open. In the tournament, she defeated world number 17 in the quarterfinal, world number 23 in the semifinal, and world number 10 Georgina Kennedy in the final (12-10, 11-5, 11-7).

25. Which state leads the country in rooftop solar installations under PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSG: MBY)?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Uttar Pradesh
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Gujarat

More than 26 lakh households in India have benefited from PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSG: MBY) since its launch in February 2024. 20,85,514 rooftop solar (RTS)



systems have been installed nationwide, providing clean energy access. Rs 14,771.82 crore in Central Financial Assistance (CFA) has been disbursed up to December 2025. The scheme allows eligible grid-connected residential consumers to install solar panels via the national portal. Gujarat leads with 5.15 lakh installations benefiting 7.41 lakh households, followed by Maharashtra (3.92 lakh) and Uttar Pradesh (3.26 lakh). The programme promotes affordable household solar energy and supports India's clean energy transition.

26. Where was the World Government Summit 2026 held?

- [A] Abu Dhabi
- [B] Dubai
- [C] Riyadh
- [D] Doha

Answer: Dubai

The World Government Summit 2026 opened in Dubai under the theme "Shaping Future Governments", focusing on innovation, sustainability, and technology in public policy. The summit includes more than 445 sessions with over 450 global leaders, including presidents, ministers, and experts. Discussions focus on strengthening government policies, international cooperation, economic, social, and technological challenges, and the future of public finance and leadership. Tariff volatility and inflationary concerns were mitigated as global trade adjusted, with effective tariffs around 9% versus earlier estimates of 20%.

27. The first Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) under the Government of India's Shipbuilding Development Scheme has been formed in which state?

- [A] Kerala
- [B] Tamil Nadu
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Tamil Nadu

The first Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) under India's Shipbuilding Development Scheme (SbDS) has been formed: National Shipbuilding & Heavy Industries Park, Tamil Nadu (NSHIP, TN). It is a 50:50 Joint Venture between VOC Port (GoI) and SIPCOT (State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu). The Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) will create a roadmap for the Thoothukudi Greenfield Shipbuilding Cluster, access central funding, enable digital and technical infrastructure, and strengthen Centre-State-industry collaboration with global partners.

28. Where was the 10th Mising Youth Festival (2026) held?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Nagaland
- [C] Manipur
- [D] Sikkim

Answer: Assam

The 10th Mising Youth Festival 2026 was held from 26-30 January at Kareng Chapori,



Dhemaji, Assam. It celebrates the heritage of the Mising tribe through traditional music, dance, and art. The festival was organized by Takam Mising Porin Kebang (TMPK) to showcase the culture of the Brahmaputra Valley's riparian community. The event emphasizes that protection of tribal rights, culture, language, literature, and music is achieved through cultural unity, not conflict. The Donyi-Polo tradition of the Mising community teaches that worshipping nature is equivalent to worshipping God.

29. Punatsangchhu-II Hydroelectric Project, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Nepal
- [B] Bhutan
- [C] China
- [D] India

Answer: Bhutan

India and Bhutan discussed better commercial use of power from Punatsangchhu-II Hydroelectric Project (1020 Megawatt) and early start of Punatsangchhu-I Hydroelectric Project (1200 Megawatt). Punatsangchhu-II is a 1020 Megawatt run-of-the-river hydropower project. It is located on the right bank of the Punatsangchhu River in Wangdue Phodrang district of Bhutan. The project is developed under an Inter-Governmental Agreement between the Royal Government of Bhutan and the Government of India. Funding is provided by Government of India with 30 percent grant and 70 percent loan at 10 percent annual interest.

30. Project Himank operates primarily in which region of India?

- [A] Ladakh
- [B] Arunachal Pradesh
- [C] Sikkim
- [D] Himachal Pradesh

Answer: Ladakh

A rare snow leopard sighting by Project Himank highlights successful wildlife conservation along with infrastructure growth in the High Himalayas. Project Himank is a Border Roads Organization (BRO) initiative started in 1985 in the Ladakh region of India. Its main objective is to develop and maintain road communication in Ladakh's high-altitude and harsh terrain. It ensures strategic connectivity near the Line of Actual Control (LAC) with China.

31. Exercise KHANJAR is a bilateral military exercise conducted between India and which country?

- [A] Malaysia
- [B] Indonesia
- [C] Kyrgyzstan
- [D] Malaysia

Answer: Kyrgyzstan

The 13th edition of Exercise KHANJAR, a joint military exercise between India and Kyrgyzstan, has started at Misamari in Sonitpur district of Assam. Exercise KHANJAR is an



annual Joint Special Forces exercise conducted by both countries. The exercise is held alternately in India and the Kyrgyz Republic every year. Khanjar-XIII is a 14-day-long exercise aimed at improving interoperability between Special Forces. The 2026 edition focuses on urban warfare and counter-terrorism operations under the United Nations mandate.

32. A new flowering plant species named *Dicliptera pakhalica* was recently discovered in which protected area of Telangana?

- [A] Amrabad Tiger Reserve
- [B] Pakhal Wildlife Sanctuary
- [C] Eturnagaram Wildlife Sanctuary
- [D] Kinnersani Wildlife Sanctuary

Answer: Pakhal Wildlife Sanctuary

Scientists from the Botanical Survey of India (BSI) discovered a new flowering plant species named *Dicliptera pakhalica*. The discovery was made in Pakhal Wildlife Sanctuary located in Warangal district of Telangana. The sanctuary is dominated by mixed deciduous forest vegetation. The area has rich plant diversity including bamboo and teak trees.

33. Dholpur-Karauli Tiger Reserve is located in which state?

- [A] Rajasthan
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Rajasthan

The Rajasthan Forest and Environment Minister stated that villagers in Dholpur-Karauli Tiger Reserve will not be relocated without their consent. Dholpur-Karauli Tiger Reserve is located in eastern Rajasthan across Dholpur and Karauli districts. It shares ecological continuity with Ranthambhore Tiger Reserve towards the west. The reserve lies close to the Chambal River in the east, which acts as a natural boundary and water source. It was officially notified in 2023 as Rajasthan's fifth tiger reserve.

34. Which port authority won the First Prize at the Swachhata Pakhwada Awards 2025?

- [A] Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority
- [B] Deendayal Port Authority
- [C] Paradip Port Authority
- [D] Chennai Port Authority

Answer: Paradip Port Authority

Paradip Port Authority (PPA) won First Prize at Swachhata Pakhwada Awards 2025 by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW). Paradip Port Authority (PPA) was recognised for excellence in cleanliness, sustainability, and community participation. The achievement reflects commitment to Swachh Bharat Abhiyan and inclusive development. Paradip Port Authority (PPA) implemented three pillars: Jan Bhagidari, Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam, and Safai Mitra Suraksha.

35. Which state has announced plans to establish India's National Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV)



Test and Innovation Corridor?

- [A] Kerala
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Odisha

Odisha government partnered with deep-tech startup BonV Aero to create a National Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV) Test and Innovation Corridor. The corridor will be set up at Rangeilunda in Ganjam district. It will be India's first commercial airport repurposed as a real-world drone testing facility. The agreement was signed at the Wings India 2026 summit in Hyderabad. BonV Aero will lead indigenous research, development, and testing of unmanned aviation systems. The corridor will allow live UAV trials in low-altitude airspace up to 1,000 metres.

36. Which city is the venue of National State Election Commissioners (SECs) Conference 2026?

- [A] New Delhi
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Bengaluru

Answer: New Delhi

Election Commission of India (ECI) will host the National Conference of State Election Commissioners (SECs) on 24 February 2026. The conference will be held at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi after a gap of more than 25 years. The last National SEC Conference was held in 1999. State Election Commissioners from all States and Union Territories will attend along with legal and technical experts. Chief Electoral Officers of all 36 States and Union Territories will also participate. The aim is to build coordination between Election Commission of India (ECI) and State Election Commissioners (SECs) in electoral processes and logistics.

37. Yuva Sahakar Scheme and Swayam Shakti Sahakar Scheme are implemented by which organization?

- [A] National Cooperative Development Corporation
- [B] National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development
- [C] Ministry of Rural Development
- [D] NITI Aayog

Answer: National Cooperative Development Corporation

National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC) is a statutory body under the Ministry of Cooperation. National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC) is implementing the Yuva Sahakar Scheme and Swayam Shakti Sahakar Scheme. Both schemes are fully funded and supported by NCDC. Yuva Sahakar Scheme aims to encourage newly formed cooperative societies with new and innovative ideas. It supports youth-led cooperatives to promote entrepreneurship and cooperative growth. Swayam Shakti Sahakar Scheme focuses on providing affordable and reliable financial services to



the poor. Details were shared by Union Minister Shri Amit Shah in a written reply in the Rajya Sabha.

38. PLASTINDIA 2026, a global plastics exhibition, was held in which city?

- [A] Bengaluru
- [B] Hyderabad
- [C] Chennai
- [D] New Delhi

Answer: New Delhi

PLASTINDIA 2026 begins on 5 February 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi and will run till 10 February. It is supported by the Department of Chemicals and Petrochemicals, Ministry of Commerce and Industry, and Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises. The theme "Bharat Next" aligns with Atmanirbhar Bharat and Viksit Bharat vision. More than 2,000 global exhibitors will display innovations in plastics, machinery, raw materials, and circular economy solutions. PLASTINDIA 2026 is India's first Zero Waste exhibition with full recycling of solid waste.

39. Pradhan Mantri Dakshta Aur Kushalta Sampann Hitgrahi Yojana (PM-DAKSH) is implemented by which Ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship
- [B] Ministry of Labour and Employment
- [C] Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- [D] Ministry of Rural Development

Answer: Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment

Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment implements Pradhan Mantri Dakshta Aur Kushalta Sampann Hitgrahi Yojana (PM-DAKSH) as a Central Sector Scheme. It provides skill training to Scheduled Castes, Other Backward Classes, Economically Weaker Sections, De-notified Tribes and Safai Karamcharis. Training is conducted in National Skill Qualification Framework (NSQF) compliant courses aligned with local market demand. Training institutes must ensure at least 70 percent wage or self-employment outcomes.

40. What is the name of operation under which Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) seized over four kilograms of Mephedrone (MD) in Rajasthan?

- [A] Operation Chakra
- [B] Operation PRAYOGSHALA
- [C] Operation Clean Drugs
- [D] Operation White Powder

Answer: Operation PRAYOGSHALA

The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) seized over four kilograms of Mephedrone (MD), a synthetic stimulant drug, from Santhore in Rajasthan. The operation was conducted jointly with the Anti Narcotics Task Force (ANTF), Rajasthan, and Jalore Police. Laboratory and industrial equipment used for manufacturing synthetic drugs were recovered. The crackdown was carried out under Operation PRAYOGSHALA. The seizure highlights intensified efforts to dismantle illegal synthetic drug manufacturing networks.



41. Esha Singh won which medal in the women's individual 10 metre air pistol event at the Asian Rifle and Pistol Championship 2026?

- [A] Gold medal
- [B] Silver medal
- [C] Bronze medal
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Gold medal

Olympian Esha Singh won gold in the women's individual 10 metre air pistol event at the Asian Rifle and Pistol Championship in Delhi. The 21-year-old scored 239.8 in the final, winning her second senior Asian Championship individual gold. Cheng Yen-Ching of Chinese Taipei won silver, while Yu Ai-Wen claimed bronze. Esha, Manu Bhaker, and Suruchi Singh won team gold in women's 10 metre air pistol with 1,726 points. Vietnam won team silver and Chinese Taipei took bronze. In men's 10 metre air pistol, world champion Samrat Rana won bronze.

42. El Chichon volcano, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Mexico
- [B] Egypt
- [C] Chile
- [D] Japan

Answer: Mexico

Unusual changes inside the crater of El Chichón volcano in southern Mexico have raised concerns among volcanologists. El Chichón, also called Chichonal, is a stratovolcano located in the forested region of north-central Chiapas, Mexico. It is the youngest volcano in the 150-kilometre long Chiapanecan Volcanic Arc. The volcano consists of multiple lava domes and a tuff ring, which is a broad ring of volcanic ash and rock. It lies between the Trans-Mexican Volcanic Belt and the Central America Volcanic Arc. El Chichón is among the most active volcanoes in Mexico and has erupted at least 12 times in the last 8,000 years.

43. Which country is the host of Asian Rifle and Pistol Championship 2027?

- [A] Malaysia
- [B] Indonesia
- [C] Japan
- [D] India

Answer: India

India will host the Asian Rifle and Pistol Championship 2027 in Delhi, a historic first for Indian shooting. The championship will offer eight Olympic quota places for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics. These eight quotas will be in addition to 12 quota places from the World Cup Shooting event. The World Cup (Rifle, Pistol, Shotgun) will be held in Delhi from 21 to 30 April 2027. Hosting rights were confirmed by the Asian Shooting Confederation to the National Rifle Association of India (NRAI).

44. Which country became the first in Europe to ban social media access for children below 16 years of age?



- [A] France
- [B] Germany
- [C] Spain
- [D] Italy

Answer: Spain

Spain has announced a nationwide ban on social media access for children below 16 years of age. It became the first European country and the second globally after Australia to take this step. The ban is expected to come into force within a week. Social media companies must enforce strict age verification and compliance. Australia introduced a similar ban in December 2025, leading to removal of over 5.5 lakh underage accounts. The move may influence other European Union countries to adopt stricter digital child protection laws.

45. Soraya Aghaei, who has been elected as the first female member of the International Olympic Committee (IOC), belongs to which country?

- [A] Iraq
- [B] Afghanistan
- [C] Iran
- [D] Egypt

Answer: Iran

On 4 February 2026, the International Olympic Committee (IOC) elected Soraya Aghaei as its first female member from Iran. She became the 107th IOC member through a 95–2 vote and is the youngest current representative at 30 years of age. She is only the third Iranian International Olympic Committee (IOC) member and the first from Iran since 2004. The International Olympic Committee (IOC) is an exclusive body of former athletes, sports leaders, royals, diplomats, industrialists, and cultural figures. Aghaei joined the IOC during the presidency of Kirsty Coventry, the first female IOC President in 132 years.

46. Which country is the host of 25th Winter Olympic Games 2026?

- [A] Italy
- [B] Spain
- [C] France
- [D] Germany

Answer: Italy

The Winter Olympics 2026, officially the 25th Winter Olympic Games, are known as Milano Cortina 2026. The Games will be held under the supervision of the International Olympic Committee (IOC). Italy will host the Olympics, marking its fourth time hosting the Olympic Games. Events will take place in Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo, famous winter sports cities in northern Italy. The Games aim to promote sportsmanship, global unity, and cultural exchange. The official logo reflects modern design, creativity, and unity between the two host cities. The official motto is "IT's Your Vibe," highlighting Italy and inviting global participation in the Olympic spirit.

47. Which country announced the launch of the Forum on Resource, Geostrategic Engagement



(FORGE) initiative?

- [A] United States
- [B] Japan
- [C] China
- [D] Russia

Answer: United States

The United States announced the launch of the Forum on Resource, Geostrategic Engagement (FORGE). The announcement was made during the inaugural Critical Minerals Ministerial held in Washington, District of Columbia (DC). The ministerial was hosted by the United States and attended by delegations from over 50 countries, including India. The event aimed to enhance cooperation to secure and diversify global critical mineral supply chains. FORGE has been created as the successor to the Minerals Security Partnership (MSP).

48. The Jhodia community, that was recently seen in news, is primarily found in which state?

- [A] Odisha
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Haryana
- [D] Rajasthan

Answer: Odisha

Union Minister of State for Tribal Affairs Shri Durgadas Uikey informed the Lok Sabha about a proposal from the Odisha government. The proposal seeks inclusion of the Jhodia community in the Scheduled Tribes (STs) list of Odisha as a synonym of Paroja at Serial Number 55. The proposal was not supported by the Office of the Registrar General of India (ORGI) and has been sent back to the State Government. The Jhodia community is an indigenous group mainly living in Rayagada and Koraput districts of Odisha. Inclusion of a community in the ST list requires a proposal from the State along with an ethnographic report.

49. Which state is the host of Exercise Vayu Shakti 2026?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Punjab
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Himachal Pradesh

Answer: Rajasthan

The Indian Air Force (IAF) will conduct its largest day-and-night air power exercise, Vayu Shakti-2026, on 27 February at the Pokaran Field Firing Range in Jaisalmer, Rajasthan. The exercise will test operational strategy, precision strikes, and weapon systems against simulated enemy targets like bunkers, bridges, and operation rooms. It will be held at the Chandan Field Firing Range near Pokaran, with a full dress rehearsal on 24 February. Operations will be showcased during day, dusk, and night phases.

50. The New Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty (New START) was signed between which two countries?



- [A] Russia and China
- [B] Israel and India
- [C] United States and Russia
- [D] United States and France

Answer: United States and Russia

The Russian Foreign Ministry informed that the New START nuclear arms control treaty between Russia and the United States has expired on February 5. The two countries are no longer bound by its obligations, though Russia remains open to diplomatic efforts to maintain strategic stability and a future agreement. Moscow remains open to political and diplomatic efforts to maintain strategic stability. New START was signed in 2010 and entered into force in 2011. It limited deployed nuclear warheads and delivery systems.

51. Black Swan Summit India was organised by which state government under the BharatNetra initiative?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Odisha

The two-day Black Swan Summit India has begun in Bhubaneswar, organised by the Odisha Government under the BharatNetra initiative. The summit aims to position Odisha as a hub for Artificial Intelligence, FinTech, and InsurTech. It seeks to translate the state's Vision 2036–2047 into actionable outcomes in digital finance and advanced technologies. Nearly 100 speakers from five continents are participating. Skill development and employment are key themes, with a job fair for youth.

52. Which district has become the first in India to achieve 100% insurance coverage under "Insurance for All by 2047"?

- [A] Satna, Madhya Pradesh
- [B] Sonapat, Haryana
- [C] Meerut, Madhya Pradesh
- [D] Alwar, Rajasthan

Answer: Alwar, Rajasthan

Alwar (Rajasthan) becomes first district in India to achieve 100% insurance coverage under 'Insurance for All by 2047' roadmap. Roadmap aligns with vision of 'Secure India-Insured India' at grassroots level. It is a joint initiative by Government of India and Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) under Ministry of Finance. Achievement covers nine villages: Bhulla Ka Bas, Bichpuri, Palankheda, Antapada, Hanumanta, Kalyanpura, Morodkhurd, Kodalka, Lalpur.

53. NAMASTE scheme is a joint initiative of which two ministries?

- [A] Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment and Ministry of Finance
- [B] Ministry of Rural Development and Ministry of Agriculture
- [C] Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment and Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs



[D] Ministry of Home Affairs and Ministry of Agriculture

Answer: Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment and Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs

The Union government released enumeration data of 1.52 lakh waste pickers under the National Action for Mechanized Sanitation Ecosystem (NAMASTE) scheme. The enumeration was conducted using the Waste Picker Enumeration App, launched in 2025. About 84.5% of waste pickers belong to SC, ST, and OBC communities, while 10.7% are from the General category, mainly in Delhi and Goa. NAMASTE scheme is a joint initiative by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment and the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. NAMASTE scheme replaced the Self-Employment Scheme for Rehabilitation of Manual Scavengers (SRMS). The National Safai Karamcharis Finance & Development Corporation implements the scheme.

54. The International Day of Zero Tolerance for Female Genital Mutilation (FGM) is observed every year on which day?

[A] February 3

[B] February 4

[C] February 5

[D] February 6

Answer: February 6

The International Day of Zero Tolerance for Female Genital Mutilation (FGM) is observed on 6 February each year. This observance highlights the harmful effects of Female Genital Mutilation (FGM) and promotes human rights and women's health. About 4.5 million girls, many under five, are at risk each year, with 22.7 million more projected by 2030. Ending Female Genital Mutilation (FGM) requires community engagement, strong health and education systems, and sustained investment.

55. Which country won the U19 Cricket World Cup 2026?

[A] India

[B] England

[C] Zimbabwe

[D] South Africa

Answer: India

India won the U19 Cricket World Cup 2026, defeating England by 100 runs in the final held in Harare, Zimbabwe. India batted first, scoring 411/9 in 50 overs, while England were bowled out for 311 in 40.2 overs chasing a target of 412. Vaibhav Suryavanshi (14 years old) starred with 175 runs off 80 balls, laying the foundation for India's win. Captain Ayush Mhatre contributed 53 runs off 51 balls. This is India's sixth U19 World Cup title and the largest margin of victory by runs in a U19 final.

56. According to recent data, which state recorded the largest decline in National Highway fatalities between 2024 and 2025?

[A] Madhya Pradesh

[B] Punjab



[C] Uttar Pradesh

[D] Haryana

Answer: Uttar Pradesh

Road accidents and fatalities on National Highways (NHs) declined by over 11% in 2025, according to data presented by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) in Lok Sabha. In 2025, National Highways recorded 1,34,307 accidents and 57,482 deaths, compared to 1,50,958 accidents and 64,772 deaths in 2024. This marked the first decline in three years, after 1,50,177 accidents and 63,112 deaths in 2023. The reduction was mainly driven by Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Punjab, Chhattisgarh, and Telangana, which together reduced fatalities by 6,072. Uttar Pradesh saw the largest drop, from 9,560 deaths in 2024 to 6,973 in 2025, followed by Madhya Pradesh with 1,762 fewer deaths.

57. Agni-III intermediate-range ballistic missile is developed by which organization?

[A] Indian Space Research Organisation

[B] Bharat Dynamics Limited

[C] Hindustan Aeronautics Limited

[D] Defence Research and Development Organisation

Answer: Defence Research and Development Organisation

India successfully test-fired the Agni-III ballistic missile from the Integrated Test Range, Chandipur, Odisha. The launch was conducted under the supervision of the Strategic Forces Command (SFC) as a routine training exercise. The test aimed to validate the operational readiness and technical performance of the missile system. All mission objectives were met, and all parameters were successfully validated, according to defence officials. Agni-III is developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO). It is a two-stage, solid-fuelled intermediate-range ballistic missile with a range exceeding 3,000 kilometres.

58. Operation Shastra was launched by which police force to take action against individuals posting photos with weapons?

[A] Mumbai Police

[B] Uttar Pradesh Police

[C] Madhya Pradesh Police

[D] Delhi Police

Answer: Delhi Police

Delhi Police launched Operation Shastra to take action against individuals posting photos with weapons and using abusive language on social media. The operation targets people who attempt to create fear and intimidation through online platforms, according to Joint Commissioner SK Jain (Southern Range). The drive involved more than 500 police teams and more than 2,000 police personnel. Action was taken after monitoring more than 6,000 social media profiles. A total of 61 First Information Reports (FIRs) were registered during the operation. So far, 83 accused persons have been apprehended, highlighting the success of Operation Shastra.

59. What is the main theme of the National Conference on Naturopathy 2026?



- [A] National Conference on Naturopathy-2026
- [B] Yoga Research and Lifestyle Disorders
- [C] SamYog for Sustainable Healthcare
- [D] Yoga and Naturopathy for a Stronger and Healthier You

Answer: Yoga and Naturopathy for a Stronger and Healthier You

Eminent experts and researchers at the National Conference on Naturopathy-2026, held on 5-6 February 2026, stressed the need for evidence-based integration of Yoga and Naturopathy in preventive, promotive, and rehabilitative healthcare. The conference was jointly organised by the Morarji Desai National Institute of Yoga (MDNIY) and the Central Council for Research in Yoga & Naturopathy (CCRYN) under the Ministry of Ayush, Government of India. The main theme of the conference was “Yoga and Naturopathy for a Stronger and Healthier You”, with the sub-theme “SamYog” focusing on integrating Ayush systems with modern medicine for public health interventions.

60. Which state government has launched the AI-based digital learning initiative ‘Padhai with AI’?

- [A] Punjab
- [B] Haryana
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Himachal Pradesh

Answer: Himachal Pradesh

Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu launched the Bilaspur district initiative “Padhai with Artificial Intelligence (AI)” at Barthin. It is an AI-based digital learning platform for Bilaspur students preparing for competitive examinations. The initiative ensures equal learning opportunities, a fully digital system, and continuous academic counselling. It provides modern, technology-driven quality education with support from National Thermal Power Corporation (NTPC).

61. Recently, the world’s longest measured snake was confirmed by Guinness World Records from which country?

- [A] India
- [B] Philippines
- [C] Indonesia
- [D] Malaysia

Answer: Indonesia

A giant female reticulated python found in Sulawesi, Indonesia, is confirmed by Guinness World Records as the longest measured snake at 7.22 metres. The reticulated python belongs to the Pythonidae family and its scientific name is *Malayopython reticulatus*. It is the world’s longest snake and the third heaviest after the green anaconda and Burmese python. It is a non-venomous constrictor that kills prey by tightening its coils. It is native to South and Southeast Asia, living in tropical forests of India, Indonesia, and nearby regions. Its conservation status is Least Concern under the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN).

62. Dalma Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?



- [A] Jharkhand
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Jharkhand

The Jharkhand Tourism Minister launched a jungle safari and laid the foundation for 30 eco-cottages at Dalma Wildlife Sanctuary. Dalma Wildlife Sanctuary is located in East Singhbhum district of Jharkhand. It lies around the Dalma Hills on the Chotanagpur Plateau. The sanctuary is named after "Dalma Mai," a local goddess worshipped by nearby communities. Its forests fall within the catchment of the Subarnarekha River and Dimna Lake near Jamshedpur.

63. Which country is the host of Esports Nations Cup 2026 (ENC)?

- [A] Saudi Arabia
- [B] China
- [C] Qatar
- [D] Egypt

Answer: Saudi Arabia

The Esports World Cup Foundation included chess among 16 titles at the first Esports Nations Cup 2026 in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, from 2–29 November 2026. The chess event will run from 2–8 November 2026 with 128 players representing nations, maximum two per country. The tournament starts with 16 round-robin groups of eight players, with top four advancing to knockouts.

64. Which mission was launched by Ministry of Agriculture to promote self-reliance in pulse production in February 2026?

- [A] Pulse Development Programme
- [B] Atmanirbhar Krishi Mission
- [C] Pulse Self-Reliance Mission
- [D] National Food Security Mission

Answer: Pulse Self-Reliance Mission

Union Minister of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Shivraj Singh Chouhan launched the nationwide Pulse Self-Reliance Mission in Amlaha, Sehore district of Madhya Pradesh. The launch took place at the Food Legumes Research Centre (FLRP) with participation of central and state leaders. The mission aims to make India self-reliant in pulses and a global exporter. It plans to establish 1,000 pulse processing mills across the country. The mission will strengthen research and farmer linkages to improve productivity. Self-reliance in pulses is seen as a key pillar of Atmanirbhar Bharat.

65. The Sharda River, that was recently seen in news, is a transboundary river flowing through India and which country?

- [A] Nepal
- [B] Bhutan
- [C] Myanmar



[D] Bangladesh

Answer: Nepal

The Uttarakhand Chief Minister laid the foundation stone of the Sharda River Corridor at Tanakpur in Champawat district. The Sharda River is a transboundary river flowing through northern India and western Nepal. It originates as the Kali River in far northern Uttarakhand in the Great Himalayas. The river rises on the eastern slopes of the Nanda Devi massif. Its major tributaries include the Dhauliganga, Goriganga, and Sarju rivers.

66. The Jiyo Parsi Scheme is implemented under which Union Ministry?

[A] Ministry of Culture

[B] Ministry of Home Affairs

[C] Ministry of Women and Child Development

[D] Ministry of Minority Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Minority Affairs

The Jiyo Parsi Scheme has supported the birth of over 490 Parsi children across India. It has provided financial assistance of ₹35.05 crore to Parsi couples. Jiyo Parsi is a unique Central Sector Scheme launched in 2013–14. The scheme is implemented by the Ministry of Minority Affairs. It aims to arrest the declining population of the Parsi community. The scheme uses scientific protocols and structured interventions. Its goal is to stabilise and gradually increase the Parsi population in India.

67. Thwaites Glacier, that was recently seen in news, is located in which region?

[A] Antarctica

[B] Himalayas

[C] Nigeria

[D] Greece

Answer: Antarctica

Scientists warned that the Thwaites Glacier is melting rapidly due to human-induced climate change. It is a massive glacier in West Antarctica, often called the Doomsday Glacier. The glacier is very wide and fast-flowing, roughly the size of Florida or Great Britain. It is extremely important because it already contributes about 4% to global annual sea-level rise. Studies show it is thinning, retreating, and adding more meltwater to the oceans. If it collapses, it could destabilise the West Antarctic Ice Sheet, causing severe sea-level rise.

68. The Sawalkote Hydroelectric Project is located on which river?

[A] Jhelum

[B] Ravi

[C] Chenab

[D] Beas

Answer: Chenab

India began work on the Sawalkote Hydroelectric Project on the Chenab River in Jammu and Kashmir. It is a 1,856 megawatt run-of-the-river hydropower project located in Ramban district. It will be the largest hydroelectric project in the Union Territory and



among the biggest in North India. Planned since the 1980s, it was revised multiple times to address environmental and technical issues. The project will be built by National Hydroelectric Power Corporation (NHPC) with nine turbines and an underground power station.

69. Which state/UT has become the first in the country to formally partner with Bharat Taxi's co-operative mobility platform?

- [A] Delhi
- [B] Haryana
- [C] Jammu and Kashmir
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Delhi

Delhi became the first state to partner with Bharat Taxi's cooperative mobility platform to improve safe, reliable, and transparent taxi services. The Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation (DTTDC) signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Sahkar Taxi Cooperative Limited (STCL). Sahkar Taxi Cooperative Limited (STCL) is the cooperative, driver-owned arm of Bharat Taxi providing technology-enabled mobility services. Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation (DTTDC) will act as tourism and branding partner and train drivers in soft skills, culture, and heritage. The initiative will offer point-to-point travel and curated sightseeing circuits for tourists.

70. The Sahyog portal is an initiative of which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] Ministry of Law and Justice
- [C] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [D] Ministry of Home Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Home Affairs

The Delhi High Court ruled that "safe harbour" protection under Section 79 of the Information Technology Act, 2000 does not exempt intermediaries from participating in the Sahyog portal. Section 79 provides immunity to digital intermediaries for third-party content if they act only as neutral hosts. The Sahyog portal is an initiative of the Ministry of Home Affairs to strengthen cybercrime prevention and enforcement. It aims to support prevention, detection, investigation, and prosecution of cybercrime. The portal automates sending of legal notices to intermediaries under the IT Act, 2000.

71. Kordofan region, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Egypt
- [B] Greece
- [C] Sudan
- [D] Israel

Answer: Sudan

A drone attack by Sudan's Rapid Support Forces (RSF) hit a vehicle carrying displaced families near Rahad in North Kordofan. The victims were civilians fleeing violence in the



conflict-affected region. The incident highlights the worsening humanitarian crisis and continued violence in Sudan's ongoing conflict. Kordofan is a large region in central and southern Sudan, lying between Darfur in the west and the White Nile River valley in the east. The northern part is arid desert with sandy soils, sparse vegetation, and thorny shrubs. The southern part has clay plains with the Nuba Mountains rising up to about 900 metres.

72. World Pulses Day is observed every year on which day?

- [A] February 9
- [B] February 10
- [C] February 11
- [D] February 12

Answer: February 10

World Pulses Day is observed every year on 10 February as a United Nations (UN)-designated global observance. It highlights the role of pulses like lentils, chickpeas, beans, and peas in nutrition, food security, and sustainable agriculture. Pulses are affordable, nutrient-rich, and major vegetarian protein sources for billions of people. The day promotes increased production and consumption to improve diets and reduce environmental impact. It supports the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, especially goals on hunger, nutrition, climate action, and sustainability.

73. What is the rank of India in the Network Readiness Index 2025 (NRI 2025)?

- [A] 43rd
- [B] 44th
- [C] 45th
- [D] 47th

Answer: 45th

India improved its rank by four places to 45th in the Network Readiness Index (NRI) 2025, released on 4 February 2026. The index assesses 127 economies across four pillars: Technology, People, Governance, and Impact, using 53 indicators. The report is prepared by the Portulans Institute, a non-profit research body based in Washington DC. India's score increased from 53.63 in 2024 to 54.43 in 2025 out of 100. India ranked 1st in telecom investment, Artificial Intelligence (AI) publications, Information and Communication Technology (ICT) exports, and e-commerce laws. It ranked 2nd in Fibre to the Home (FTTH) subscriptions and internet traffic, showing strong digital growth.

74. Sahyadri Tiger Reserve (STR) is located in which state?

- [A] Odisha
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Maharashtra

A third tigress was recently released into the wild at Sahyadri Tiger Reserve (STR), boosting tiger conservation in western Maharashtra. Sahyadri Tiger Reserve (STR) is located in the



Sahyadri Ranges of the Western Ghats, Maharashtra, and is the northernmost tiger habitat in the Western Ghats. It is the first tiger reserve of Western Maharashtra and the fourth in the state.

75. National Deworming Day (NDD) is observed on which day every year?

- [A] February 9
- [B] February 10
- [C] February 11
- [D] February 12

Answer: February 10

National Deworming Day (NDD) 2026 is observed on 10 February across India. It targets intestinal worm infections in children and adolescents aged 1–19 years. Coordinated by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, it provides free albendazole tablets in government schools, private schools, and Anganwadi centres. National Deworming Day (NDD) ensures coverage in remote villages, urban slums, and suburban areas simultaneously. The day was launched in 2015 under the National Health Mission, initially in 11 states/UTs, targeting 140 million children. By 2018, it expanded nationwide, making it the world's largest single-day school-based deworming program.

76. Mons Mouton has been identified as a potential landing zone for which Indian mission?

- [A] Chandrayaan-2
- [B] Chandrayaan-3
- [C] Chandrayaan-4
- [D] LUPEX Mission

Answer: Chandrayaan-4

Scientists from Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) Space Applications Centre (SAC) have selected Mons Mouton as the landing site for Chandrayaan-4, India's first lunar sample return mission. Mons Mouton is a 6,000-metre-high mountain near the Moon's South Pole with a largely flat peak suitable for safe landing. It lies in the South Circumpolar Region (SCR) and is named after NASA mathematician Melba Roy Mouton. The site is located on the rim of the South Pole–Aitken basin, the Moon's oldest and largest impact basin. The region receives long-duration sunlight and has clear radio communication with Earth.

77. Safer Internet Day 2026 is observed on which day?

- [A] February 9
- [B] February 10
- [C] February 11
- [D] February 12

Answer: February 10

Safer Internet Day is observed globally on the second Tuesday of February to promote safe and responsible internet use, especially for children and youth. In 2026, Safer Internet Day falls on 10 February and highlights growing digital risks in daily online life. Safer Internet Day 2026 in India focuses on awareness and informed digital behaviour.



The theme for 2026 is “Smart Tech, Safe Choices: Exploring the Safe and Responsible Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI).”

78. Which country launched iLive Connect, the world’s first doctor-led Artificial Intelligence (AI) healthcare ecosystem?

- [A] India
- [B] France
- [C] Malaysia
- [D] Singapore

Answer: India

India launched iLive Connect, the world’s first doctor-led Artificial Intelligence (AI) healthcare ecosystem for continuous home-based clinical monitoring. It bridges gaps in chronic disease care and post-hospital recovery, especially for elderly and remote-area patients. The system uses medical-grade wearable biosensors, a chest patch and wristband, to track ECG, heart rate, respiration, oxygen saturation (SpO₂), temperature, blood pressure trends, activity, sleep, and heart rate variability. Data is sent in real time to a 24×7 medical command centre staffed by specialist doctors.

79. The Buddy Squadron aerial exercise is conducted between South Korea and which country?

- [A] United States
- [B] France
- [C] Germany
- [D] Russia

Answer: United States

South Korean and United States air forces have started the Buddy Squadron joint aerial exercise at Osan Air Base in Pyeongtaek. The exercise aims to improve interoperability and integrated tactical skills between the two allies. Buddy Squadron is a battalion-level drill conducted alternately by South Korea and the United States. It focuses on sharing air-to-air combat tactics and integrated training. The exercise involves fourth- and fifth-generation fighter jets. It strengthens joint operational readiness and regional security cooperation.

80. The International Day of Women and Girls in Science is observed every year on which day?

- [A] February 9
- [B] February 10
- [C] February 11
- [D] February 12

Answer: February 11

The International Day of Women and Girls in Science is observed every year on 11 February under the leadership of the United Nations (UN), with United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) playing a key role. It was established by the United Nations General Assembly in December 2015 and first observed in 2016 to address low participation of women in Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM). The 2026 theme is “From Vision to Impact: Redefining STEM by



Closing the Gender Gap,” focusing on action and implementation.

81. Mangrove clams, that were recently seen in news, are widely distributed in which region?

- [A] Indo-Pacific region
- [B] Arctic region
- [C] Mediterranean region
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Indo-Pacific region

Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)–Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (CMFRI) has achieved captive breeding of the mangrove clam *Geloina erosa*. Mangrove clams, also called mud clams or ‘Kandal Kakka’ in northern Kerala, belong to the genus *Polymesoda* or *Geloina*. They live in muddy, brackish, and near-freshwater areas of mangrove swamps across the Indo-Pacific region. As a filter feeder, it recycles nutrients, stabilises sediments, supports mangrove health, and provides coastal livelihoods.

82. As per Ministry of New and Renewable Energy, what is India’s position globally in terms of renewable energy production?

- [A] First
- [B] Second
- [C] Third
- [D] Fourth

Answer: Third

India has achieved a total renewable energy capacity of 272 gigawatts, as stated by the Minister for New and Renewable Energy in the Rajya Sabha. Solar energy capacity has grown sharply from 2.8 gigawatts to 136 gigawatts. India has now become the world’s third-largest renewable energy producer. The Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahabhiyan (PM-KUSUM) scheme is benefiting rural areas through solar pumps and solarised agriculture. Several states are seeking expansion of the scheme due to its success. India is leading globally in green hydrogen, with 21 projects producing 8,300 tonnes per year commissioned so far.

83. Operation Prahar 2.0 has been launched by which state police to dismantle the entire ecosystem of organised crime?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Haryana
- [C] Punjab
- [D] Rajasthan

Answer: Punjab

Punjab Police has launched the second phase of the 72-hour-long Operation Prahar 2.0 to intensify action against gangsters and wanted criminals. This phase follows the success of Phase One, in which over 3,000 people were arrested and 69 weapons were recovered within 72 hours. The operation focuses on cracking down on organised crime networks across Punjab. Citizens are encouraged to support the drive by anonymously sharing information on criminals through the Anti-Gangster Helpline number 93946-93946.



84. Who won gold medal in men's heptathlon event at the Asian Indoor Athletics Championships 2026?

- [A] Tajinder Pal
- [B] Prateek Agarwal
- [C] Tejaswin Shankar
- [D] Adarsh Sinha

Answer: Tejaswin Shankar

India finished its campaign at the Asian Indoor Athletics Championships in Tianjin, China, with five medals and sixth place overall. Tejaswin Shankar won India's only gold by topping the men's heptathlon event. He scored 5,993 points, setting a new national indoor record and improving his 2021 mark. Pooja won silver in the high jump. Tajinderpal Singh Toor secured silver in the shot put. Ancy Sojan claimed bronze in the long jump. Aadrash Ram Jothi Shankar won bronze in High Jump.

85. The 'Vocal for Local' initiative was launched by which organization?

- [A] NITI Aayog
- [B] Ministry of Women and Child Development
- [C] Reserve Bank of India
- [D] Capacity Building Commission

Answer: NITI Aayog

The 'Vocal for Local' initiative is empowering artisans by giving wider markets to handmade products and promoting self-reliance. Its impact was seen at Handicrafts Exhibition-2026 held in Guna, Madhya Pradesh. The exhibition was organised by the Union Ministry of Textiles with Madhya Pradesh State Cooperative Federation Limited. The 'Vocal for Local' initiative was launched by NITI Aayog under the Aspirational Blocks Programme. It aims to promote indigenous products, strengthen local economies, and foster self-reliance (Atmanirbhar Bharat).

86. Public Financial Management System is developed and implemented by which government body?

- [A] Reserve Bank of India
- [B] Controller General of Accounts (CGA)
- [C] Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG)
- [D] NITI Aayog

Answer: Controller General of Accounts (CGA)

Minister of State for Finance informed Rajya Sabha about Public Financial Management System. Public Financial Management System is a web-based online transaction platform for fund management and e-payment to agencies and beneficiaries. It provides end-to-end financial management services as a centralized transaction system. It is developed and implemented by Controller General of Accounts under Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance, Government of India. It ensures efficient fund flow and payment-cum-accounting network.

87. Who has become India's youngest male analog astronaut after successfully completing a



simulated lunar habitat mission?

- [A] Aditya Pandya
- [B] Swastik Sinha
- [C] Saurabh Dutt
- [D] Piyush Chawla

Answer: Aditya Pandya

India's expanding space programme is inspiring young students to join space research activities. Aditya Pandya, a 17-year-old student, became India's youngest male analog astronaut. He completed a simulated lunar habitat mission under Moon-like conditions. The mission was organised by AAKA Space Studio, a space research and simulation organisation. It was conducted at Dholavira in Gujarat. The mission duration was from 1 February to 8 February 2026. It aimed to simulate isolation and operational challenges similar to real space missions.

88. Which team won the 79th National Football Championship for the Santosh Trophy?

- [A] Services
- [B] Assam
- [C] Railways
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Services

Services won the 79th National Football Championship for Santosh Trophy. The final was played at Dhakuakhana Stadium in Assam. Services defeated Kerala by 1-0 in a closely fought match. The winning goal was scored in the 109th minute of extra time. Striker Abhishek Pawar scored from a cross delivered by Shubham Rana. This victory marked Services' eighth Santosh Trophy title. Services had also defeated Kerala in the 2023-24 season final.

89. What is the rank of India in the 2025 Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI)?

- [A] 67th
- [B] 77th
- [C] 89th
- [D] 91st

Answer: 91st

Global corruption is rising as per Transparency International's 2025 Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI). Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) measures perceived public sector corruption in 182 countries. It uses a scale from 0 (highly corrupt) to 100 (very clean). Only 5 countries scored above 80, down from 12 a decade ago. The global average score fell to 42, the lowest in over ten years. 122 countries scored below 50, showing serious corruption concerns. Denmark ranked first with 89; South Sudan and Somalia ranked last with 9. India ranked 91st with a score of 39, showing slight improvement.

90. Which state/UT has launched Lakhpati Bitiya Yojana for welfare of girls?

- [A] Delhi
- [B] Uttarakhand



[C] Gujarat

[D] Ladakh

Answer: Delhi

Delhi Government launched Lakhpati Bitiya Yojana for welfare of girls. The scheme supports daughters from birth till completion of graduation. Total financial assistance of ₹56,000 will be given in instalments. After completing education, the scheme will mature into over ₹1 lakh. The scheme links social security with education-based incentives. It promotes gender equity, financial inclusion and human capital development. Beneficiary data will be digitally updated regularly. It aims to provide financial support and confidence to girls.

91. National Productivity Day is observed every year on which day?

[A] February 11

[B] February 12

[C] February 13

[D] February 14

Answer: February 12

National Productivity Day is observed on 12 February to mark the foundation of National Productivity Council (NPC). National Productivity Week is celebrated from 12 to 18 February 2026. Theme is "Clusters as Growth Engine: Maximizing Productivity in Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)". It focuses on manufacturing competitiveness and sustainable industrial growth. Cluster-based development supports global value chain integration. NPC was established in 1958 under Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT). NPC is part of Asian Productivity Organisation (APO).

92. What is the name of the scheme implemented by National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC) to promote young cooperative entrepreneurs?

[A] Sahakar Mitra Scheme

[B] Yuva Sahakar Scheme

[C] Stand-Up Cooperative Scheme

[D] Cooperative Startup Yojana

Answer: Yuva Sahakar Scheme

National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC) implements Yuva Sahakar – Cooperative Enterprise Support and Innovation Scheme under Start-up India and Stand-up India. The scheme promotes newly formed cooperatives with innovative ideas and supports societies operational for at least three months. NCDC provides easy financing with 2% interest subvention on term loans. Funding is project-based and provided after application; no proposal was received from Jharkhand. Cooperatives must contribute 30% of project cost as equity.

93. White Revolution 2.0 has been launched by which ministry?

[A] Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare

[B] Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying

[C] Ministry of Cooperation



[D] Ministry of Rural Development

Answer: Ministry of Cooperation

Union Minister for Home and Cooperation Amit Shah informed in Lok Sabha that the Centre launched White Revolution 2.0 under Ministry of Cooperation. The initiative aims to expand dairy cooperatives, generate employment and strengthen women's empowerment. Milk procurement by dairy cooperatives is targeted to increase by 50% to 1,007 lakh kilogram per day by 2028-29. Around 75,000 new Dairy Cooperative Societies (DCS) will be established and 46,422 existing DCS will be strengthened. The scheme will reduce post-harvest losses, improve income and enhance nutritional security.

94. Which state is the host of National Mountain Bike Cycling Championship 2026?

[A] Sikkim

[B] Arunachal Pradesh

[C] Uttarakhand

[D] Himachal Pradesh

Answer: Arunachal Pradesh

The 22nd Senior, Junior and Sub-Junior National Mountain Bike Cycling Championship is scheduled to take place at Roing, Arunachal Pradesh from 12 to 15 February 2026. The event is organised under the aegis of Cycling Federation of India and hosted by Cycling Association of Arunachal Pradesh. Cyclists from various states and institutions across the country will participate. It is a prestigious and highly competitive national-level championship. The participating team will be guided by a Coach-cum-Manager during the competition.

95. Which two cities have been selected by the Tamil Nadu Government for establishing pet parks?

[A] Chennai and Madurai

[B] Chennai and Coimbatore

[C] Coimbatore and Tiruchirapalli

[D] Madurai and Salem

Answer: Chennai and Coimbatore

Tamil Nadu Government has decided to establish and maintain pet parks in Chennai and Coimbatore with private participation. The initiative aims to promote safe pet ownership and compassionate animal care. Private charitable organisations, Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs) and animal welfare groups with prior experience are invited to apply. Selected organisations will develop and maintain parks using their own funds. Facilities will include play equipment, green lawns, pet shops, training equipment and rule handbooks.

96. Gilbert Hill, that was recently highlighted in news, is located in which state?

[A] Maharashtra

[B] Gujarat

[C] Karnataka

[D] Kerala

Answer: Maharashtra



Gilbert Hill recently came into news after industrialist Anand Mahindra highlighted it in a social media post. The discussion increased awareness about its rare volcanic origin and heritage significance. Gilbert Hill is a 200-foot high monolith of black basalt rock located in Andheri, Mumbai, Maharashtra. It is one of the oldest basalt rock formations, formed about 66 million years ago during the Mesozoic era. It was created by volcanic eruptions that formed the Deccan Traps and marked the end of the dinosaur age. It is a rare volcanic column, with only three similar formations worldwide. The other two are Devil's Tower in the United States of America (USA) and Giant's Causeway in Northern Ireland.

97. What is the primary objective of the National Large Solar Telescope (NLST)?

- [A] To study exoplanets outside the solar system
- [B] To study the Sun's dynamics, magnetism and space-weather processes
- [C] To observe distant galaxies and dark matter
- [D] To monitor Earth's climate change

Answer: To study the Sun's dynamics, magnetism and space-weather processes

In the Union Budget, the government approved National Large Solar Telescope (NLST) and National Large Optical-Near Infrared Telescope. National Large Solar Telescope (NLST) is a 2-metre aperture solar telescope being set up at Merak near Pangong Tso Lake. It will study the Sun in visible and near-infrared wavelengths of the electromagnetic spectrum. It will help in understanding solar dynamics, magnetism and space weather affecting Earth and satellites. National Large Solar Telescope (NLST) will become India's third ground-based solar observatory.

98. The Craftsmen Training Scheme (CTS) is implemented by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship
- [B] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [C] Ministry of Rural Development
- [D] Ministry of Culture

Answer: Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

Directorate General of Training (DGT) under Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE) implements Craftsmen Training Scheme (CTS) through Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) and National Skill Training Institutes (NSTIs). Training is offered in 169 trades through 14,688 ITIs and 32 NSTIs, with 14.70 lakh trainees enrolled in 2025-26. Curriculum is regularly updated with industry and State/Union Territory (UT) consultation. 31 New Age trades include Artificial Intelligence (AI), Internet of Things (IoT), renewable energy and 3D printing. PM SETU (Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs) will upgrade 1,000 ITIs with ₹60,000 crore support.

99. World Unani Day is celebrated globally every year on which day?

- [A] February 11
- [B] February 12
- [C] February 13
- [D] February 14

**Answer: February 11**

World Unani Day is observed annually on February 11th to commemorate the birth anniversary of Hakim Ajmal Khan, an eminent Indian Unani physician, scholar, and social reformer. The theme for World Unani Day 2026 is "Innovation and Evidence in Unani Practice," highlighting the integration of classical Unani wisdom with modern scientific research. The Ministry of Ayush, through the Central Council for Research in Unani Medicine (CCRUM), is organizing a two-day national conference in Mumbai on February 14-15, 2026, in hybrid mode.

100. Idukki Hydroelectric Project is located in which state?

- [A] Kerala
- [B] Andhra Pradesh
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Kerala

Idukki Hydroelectric Project in Kerala completed 50 years and Moolamattom power plant generated 115,852.672 Million Units (MU) in five decades. It is built across Periyar River in Idukki district of Kerala. It is the largest hydroelectric project in Kerala. Moolamattom powerhouse is the longest underground power station in India and has the largest pressure shaft.

101. Kala Sanskriti Vikas Yojana (KSVY) is implemented by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Education
- [B] Ministry of Tourism
- [C] Ministry of Culture
- [D] Ministry of Social Justice

Answer: Ministry of Culture

Kala Sanskriti Vikas Yojana (KSVY) is a Central Sector Scheme of Ministry of Culture that provides financial assistance to cultural organizations and artists, including Scheduled Castes, for promotion of art and performing arts across India. It has no state-wise fund allocation and includes schemes like Guru-Shishya Parampara Repertory Grant, Cultural Function and Production Grant (CFPG), Tagore Cultural Complexes (TCC), Scholarships and Fellowships, and Financial Assistance for Veteran Artists. It supports infrastructure, research, festivals, Himalayan and Buddhist heritage, and reimburses Central Goods and Services Tax (CGST) under Seva Bhoj Yojana. The scheme promotes cultural preservation, training, infrastructure creation, and supports artists financially.

102. World Radio Day is observed every year on which day?

- [A] February 12
- [B] February 13
- [C] February 14
- [D] February 15

Answer: February 13

World Radio Day is observed every year on 13 February to mark the establishment of



United Nations Radio in 1946. The theme for 2026 is "Radio and Artificial Intelligence: Artificial Intelligence (AI) is a tool, not a voice." India's first Community Radio Station was inaugurated on 1 February 2004 by Bharat Ratna Shri Lal Krishna Advani. Ram Singh Bouddh from Amroha, Uttar Pradesh, known as the "Radio Man of India," was recognised by Guinness World Records in 2025 for owning 1,257 radios, the world's largest collection.

103. Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar won which medal in men's 50 metre Rifle 3 Positions at Asian Shooting Championships 2026?

- [A] Gold medal
- [B] Silver medal
- [C] Bronze medal
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Gold medal

Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar won gold in men's 50 metre Rifle 3 Positions at Asian Shooting Championships 2026 in New Delhi with a world record score of 362.0. The event was held at Dr Karni Singh Shooting Range and he successfully defended his title. India achieved a clean sweep as Niraj Kumar won silver with 361.8 and Akhil Sheoran secured bronze with 343.5. The Indian team of Aishwary, Niraj and Akhil also won team gold, while Japan and Kazakhstan took silver and bronze. In junior category, Adriyan Karmakar won gold with 353.2 score.

104. The "Board of Peace" initiative was launched by which country?

- [A] United States
- [B] France
- [C] Germany
- [D] Russia

Answer: United States

Israel joined United States President Donald Trump's "Board of Peace" initiative during Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's visit to Washington. Netanyahu signed Israel's accession and met Trump and Secretary of State Marco Rubio. The Board was authorized by a United Nations Security Council (UNSC) resolution in November to help form an international stabilization force in Gaza. It will supervise Gaza's temporary governance and discuss reconstruction in its first meeting on February 19 in Washington. The Board plans to expand its role to address global conflicts.

105. What is the primary objective of the NALSA SAMVAD Scheme?

- [A] Ensure access to justice for marginalized tribal communities
- [B] Conduct tribal population census
- [C] Provide financial grants to rural entrepreneurs
- [D] Promote digital literacy in rural areas

Answer: Ensure access to justice for marginalized tribal communities

National Legal Services Authority (NALSA) launched NALSA SAMVAD Scheme 2025 in April 2025 to ensure access to justice for Scheduled Tribes (STs), Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) and De-Notified and Nomadic Tribes (DNTs). The scheme creates



dedicated district-level SAMVAD Units and deploys trained lawyers and para-legal volunteers from tribal areas. It provides legal aid on land and forest rights, displacement, rehabilitation, documentation and welfare schemes. It promotes legal awareness through door-to-door outreach, camps and Gram Sabha coordination in local languages.

106. Which district of Uttar Pradesh has been selected for the construction of India's first dedicated Glass Museum?

- [A] Moradabad
- [B] Firozabad
- [C] Saharanpur
- [D] Aligarh

Answer: Firozabad

India's first dedicated Glass Museum is being constructed in Firozabad, Uttar Pradesh, which is popularly known as the "Glass City of India." The project is being developed by the Uttar Pradesh Tourism Department near Vikas Bhawan at an estimated cost of around ₹47.47 crore. The three-storey museum is being built over an area of more than 25,700 square meters and will showcase the history, art, and technology of glassmaking, ranging from Harappan-era glass to modern designs.

107. Tropical Cyclone Gezani hit which country recently?

- [A] Mozambique
- [B] Madagascar
- [C] Sri Lanka
- [D] Indonesia

Answer: Madagascar

Tropical Cyclone Gezani caused widespread destruction in Madagascar after making landfall in the eastern port city of Toamasina. At least 20 people were killed and several others were injured as wind speeds exceeded 195 km per hour. Madagascar's meteorological department issued a red alert, warning of heavy rainfall, flooding, and landslides as the cyclone moved across the island nation. Toamasina, the country's main port city, suffered severe infrastructure damage, with nearly 75% of the city affected.

108. The Lion-Tailed Macaque, that was recently seen in news, is endemic to which region of India?

- [A] Eastern Himalayas
- [B] Western Ghats
- [C] Sundarbans
- [D] Aravalli Hills

Answer: Western Ghats

Researchers have cautioned that the increasing presence of lion-tailed macaques in human-dominated landscapes is largely driven by easy access to food associated with human settlements. The lion-tailed macaque is an Old World monkey and is also known as the "beard ape" due to its distinctive silver-white mane around the face. It is one of the smallest species of macaques in the world and is endemic to the evergreen rainforests of the southern Western Ghats. According to its conservation status, the lion-tailed macaque



is listed as Endangered on the IUCN Red List

109. What is the position of India in the Stanford University's 2025 Global Artificial Intelligence (AI) Vibrancy Ranking?

- [A] First
- [B] Second
- [C] Third
- [D] Fourth

Answer: Third

India ranks 3rd in Stanford University's 2025 Global Artificial Intelligence (AI) Vibrancy Ranking. Data infrastructure, entrepreneurship, and demography are identified as key drivers for AI adoption in India. According to the Stanford Global AI Index Report, AI skill penetration in India is 2.5 times higher than the global average across similar occupations. As per the National Association of Software and Service Companies (NASSCOM) AI Adoption Index, 87% of enterprises in India are actively using AI solutions. The government states that India is among the first group of AI-ready nations, progressing across applications, models, chips, infrastructure, and energy layers.

110. National Women's Day in India is observed every year on which day?

- [A] February 12
- [B] February 13
- [C] February 14
- [D] February 15

Answer: February 13

National Women's Day in India is observed every year on 13 February to mark the birth anniversary of Sarojini Naidu, known as the "Nightingale of India." She was a renowned poet, social activist, and a prominent leader in India's freedom struggle. The Government of India celebrates this day to honour her contribution to women's empowerment and the national movement. The day promotes gender equality and encourages women to make independent decisions and become leaders in their own lives.

111. Which state has become the first legislature in India to use AI-powered face-recognition technology to mark MLA attendance?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Madhya Pradesh
- [C] Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Andhra Pradesh

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

Andhra Pradesh introduced an Artificial Intelligence (AI) based face-recognition attendance system for Members of the Legislative Assembly (MLAs) in February 2026. The system was launched on 11 February 2026 at the beginning of the State Budget Session. Andhra Pradesh became the first State Legislature in India to use AI-powered face-recognition technology to mark MLA attendance. Nine AI-enabled cameras have been installed inside the Assembly to record attendance only when members sit in their allotted



seats. The main objective is to prevent proxy attendance and ensure real participation in proceedings.

112. Which paramilitary force recently planned to induct Tangkhul Hui (Haofa) and Kombai breeds to reduce dependence on foreign dog breeds?

- [A] Assam Rifles (AR)
- [B] Border Security Force (BSF)
- [C] Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP)
- [D] Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB)

Answer: Assam Rifles (AR)

Assam Rifles is planning to induct two indigenous dog breeds, Tangkhul Hui from Manipur and Kombai from Tamil Nadu, to reduce long-term dependence on foreign breeds. Assam Rifles, India's oldest paramilitary force, operates the Assam Rifles Dog Training Centre (ARDTC) at Jorhat for training service dogs. Tangkhul Hui (Haofa) is a rare indigenous breed from Ukhrul district, Manipur, traditionally reared by the Tangkhul community for hunting. Kombai, also called the Polygar dog, is an indigenous guard breed from Theni district, Tamil Nadu, named after Kombai town.

113. Which ministry has organized the National Conference on Safety of Women at Workplace (SHe-Box)?

- [A] Ministry of Labour and Employment
- [B] Ministry of Women and Child Development
- [C] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [D] Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment

Answer: Ministry of Women and Child Development

The Ministry of Women and Child Development organized the National Conference on Safety of Women at Workplace (SHe-Box) at Vigyan Bhawan on 14 February 2026. The event aimed to reaffirm the Government's commitment to safe, dignified, and harassment-free workplaces for women and strengthen implementation of the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 (PoSH Act). The SHe-Box portal, launched on 29 August 2024, provides a secure, multilingual platform for filing complaints online, automatic forwarding to concerned committees, and real-time tracking for transparency and accountability.

114. Which armed force is the host of International Military Adventure Challenge Cup (IMACC) 2026?

- [A] Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP)
- [B] Indian Coast Guard
- [C] Indian Army
- [D] Indian Air Force

Answer: Indian Army

The Indian Army will host the first-ever International Military Adventure Challenge Cup (IMACC) 2026 from 18–23 February in the foothills of the Eastern Himalayas. The event will feature military teams from India and seven friendly foreign countries: Bhutan, Brazil,



Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Saudi Arabia. Indian participants include teams from the Indian Army, Indian Air Force, Indian Coast Guard, and the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP). IMACC 2026 will involve a week-long series of adventure and endurance competitions testing physical fitness, mental resilience, teamwork, leadership, and decision-making under pressure.

115. What is the IUCN status of Himalayan Tahr that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Endangered
- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Near threatened

Answer: Near threatened

The Himalayan Tahr is facing a growing threat from garbage in the Himalayas. It is a large hoofed mammal with the scientific name *Hemitragus jemlahicus*. Its habitat spans southern Tibet, northern India, western Bhutan, and Nepal, mostly on alpine slopes between 2,500–5,000 meters. Male Himalayan Tahr weigh around 73 kg, females about 36 kg. They have a small head, pointed ears, large eyes, and backward-curving horns (males up to 46 cm, smaller in females) used in mating fights. It is listed as Near Threatened on the IUCN Red List.

116. The Sangtam community of which state has passed a resolution to protect pangolins?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Meghalaya
- [C] Manipur
- [D] Nagaland

Answer: Nagaland

The apex body of Nagaland's Sangtam community has passed a resolution to protect pangolins. The Sangtam tribe is one of the sixteen major tribes of Nagaland and a key Naga ethnic group in Northeast India. They are mainly concentrated in Kiphire and Tuensang districts, bordering Myanmar. Traditionally, they practice jhum cultivation (shifting agriculture) and follow a patriarchal system of lineage and inheritance.

117. Which ministry has announced the launch of Bharat-VISTAAR, a multilingual AI tool for agriculture?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] Ministry of Agriculture
- [C] Ministry of Rural Development
- [D] Ministry of Science and Technology

Answer: Ministry of Finance

The Finance Minister announced Bharat-VISTAAR, a multilingual AI tool to integrate AgriStack portals and ICAR's agricultural practice package with AI systems. AgriStack is a Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) for the farm sector under the Digital Agriculture Mission (DAM), approved by the Union Cabinet in September 2024. AgriStack has three foundational registries: Farmer Registry, Crop Sown Registry, and Geo-referenced Village



Maps, maintained by State Governments and Union Territories. Farmer Registry gives farmers a digital Farmer ID, linked to land records, livestock, crops, family, demographics, schemes, and benefits; target is 11 crore farmers.

118. Which country topped the medal tally at Asian Rifle/Pistol Championship 2026?

- [A] China
- [B] India
- [C] South Korea
- [D] Indonesia

Answer: India

India emerged as the overall champion at the Asian Rifle/Pistol Championship 2026 held in New Delhi, topping the medal tally with a total of 94 medals, including 51 gold, 23 silver, and 20 bronze. On the final day of the championship, Indian shooters added 6 gold, 3 silver, and 4 bronze medals, further strengthening their dominant position in the continent. The overall performance highlighted India's dominance in both individual and team events, with shooters excelling in precision, consistency, and competitive endurance across multiple disciplines.

119. Which organization launched the Davos Compact on Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR) 2025?

- [A] World Health Organization (WHO)
- [B] United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)
- [C] World Economic Forum (WEF)
- [D] United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)

Answer: World Economic Forum (WEF)

The World Economic Forum (WEF) launched the Davos Compact on Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR) 2025 to tackle the global health crisis of drug-resistant infections. It acts as a voluntary non-state counterpart to the UNGA 2024 Political Declaration on AMR, engaging non-government actors in the fight against antimicrobial resistance. The Compact sets a dual target: to prevent 100 million deaths and mitigate an estimated \$1.7 trillion economic loss by 2050 due to unchecked drug resistance. Signatories pledge to adopt the "One Health" approach, linking human, animal, and environmental health in AMR mitigation strategies. The Compact ensures equitable access to essential and newly developed antibiotics for low- and middle-income countries.

120. Where was International Conference on Evolving Landscape of Housing Finance 2026 held?

- [A] Chennai
- [B] Hyderabad
- [C] Bengaluru
- [D] New Delhi

Answer: New Delhi

Union Minister Shri Manohar Lal, Minister of Housing & Urban Affairs, graced the International Conference on Evolving Landscape of Housing Finance as Chief Guest at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, on 12–13 February 2026. The two-day conference was jointly organised by the National Housing Bank (NHB) and the Asia Pacific Union for



Housing Finance (APUHF) under the theme “Inclusivity, Stability and Sustainability.” The importance of integrated urban planning was highlighted, including transport-linked housing development and innovative mechanisms such as a National Housing Exchange-like platform supported by comprehensive housing data to reduce commute time and improve housing access.

121. The Lead Bank Scheme was introduced on the recommendations of which committee?

- [A] Narasimham Committee
- [B] Nariman Committee
- [C] Rangarajan Committee
- [D] Urjit Patel Committee

Answer: Nariman Committee

Reserve Bank of India issued draft revised guidelines for the Lead Bank Scheme for public comments. Lead Bank Scheme was introduced in December 1969 on the recommendation of the Nariman Committee. The objective of scheme is to coordinate banks and development agencies to increase bank finance to priority and other sectors. It also promotes the role of banks in overall rural development. Under the scheme, one bank is assigned as the Lead Bank for each district. The Lead Bank coordinates credit institutions and Government efforts at district level.

122. Where was International Conference on Dam Safety (ICDS 2026) held?

- [A] New Delhi
- [B] Mumbai
- [C] Bengaluru
- [D] Chennai

Answer: Bengaluru

The International Conference on Dam Safety 2026 was held at the Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru, under the Dam Rehabilitation and Improvement Project Phase II and III. The conference was organised by the Ministry of Jal Shakti, Government of Karnataka, Central Water Commission and the World Bank to strengthen dam safety in India. An Artificial Intelligence based platform named DAMCHAT was launched by ICED at IIT Roorkee to improve technical decision making. The Jal Shakti Data Management Platform of the National Water Informatics Centre was also launched to promote data driven dam management.

123. The Tamsa River, that was recently seen in news, is tributary of which river?

- [A] Ganga
- [B] Yamuna
- [C] Godavari
- [D] Narmada

Answer: Ganga

The Tamsa River, an important tributary of the Ganga River, flows through Ambedkar Nagar, Ayodhya and Azamgarh districts of eastern Uttar Pradesh. In Azamgarh, the river was revitalised under the Namami Gange Programme through coordinated administrative



action and strong community participation. A structured plan covered an 89 kilometre stretch across 111 Gram Panchayats, focusing on desilting, garbage removal, and clearing illegal encroachments. Vacant riverbank land was identified and fruit-bearing trees were planted to support ecological restoration and provide economic benefits to Gram Panchayats.

124. Which state has become the first in India to transfer Public Distribution System subsidies using Central Bank Digital Currency?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Rajasthan
- [C] Madhya Pradesh
- [D] Haryana

Answer: Gujarat

Home Minister Amit Shah launched India's first Central Bank Digital Currency based Public Distribution System on 15 February 2026 at Mahatma Mandir in Gujarat. Gujarat has become the first state to transfer Public Distribution System subsidies using Central Bank Digital Currency authorised by the Reserve Bank of India. The digital system has been developed by Punjab National Bank to ensure transparency and leak-proof delivery. Beneficiaries will receive digital wallet tokens showing item name, quantity and price. Aadhaar authentication will enable access through QR codes on smartphones and OTP on feature phones. The pilot covers 26,333 families in Sabarmati zone of Ahmedabad, Surat, Anand and Valsad.

125. The 'Suposhit Garudeshwar' mission has been launched in which state?

- [A] Haryana
- [B] Rajasthan
- [C] Punjab
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Gujarat

Union Home Minister Amit Shah has launched the 'Suposhit Garudeshwar' mission in Gujarat to combat malnutrition in the Narmada district. The mission focuses on Narmada district to reduce malnutrition and anaemia among vulnerable groups. It aims to improve nutrition levels of children below five years, adolescent girls and women of reproductive age. The initiative is part of a broader effort to strengthen the Public Distribution System and nutrition delivery. The strategy follows an integrated approach combining food security, health support and awareness measures. The programme seeks to improve overall maternal and child health indicators in the district.

126. Who topped the women's 21-km event at the second Aizawl International Half Marathon 2026?

- [A] Renu Singh
- [B] Tsige Debay Tadesse
- [C] Marta Hirpato Yota
- [D] Sudha Singh

**Answer: Renu Singh**

India's Renu Singh topped the women's 21-km event at the second Aizawl International Half Marathon on February 14, 2026. She secured the top position with a time of 1:21:22, followed by Ethiopia's Tsige Debay Tadesse and Bahrain's Marta Hirpato Yota. The race was held at the Rajiv Gandhi Stadium in Aizawl, Mizoram. Kenya's Kemboi Kevin Kiprono won the men's 21 kilometre race at the Aizawl International Half Marathon 2026. Around 3,000 runners participated, including 16 elite international athletes. Participants came from Kenya, Ethiopia, Bahrain, United Kingdom and France along with runners from across India.

127. Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0 has been launched under which initiative?

- [A] Make in India
- [B] Atmanirbhar Bharat
- [C] Stand-Up India
- [D] Startup India

Answer: Startup India

Recently, the Union Cabinet chaired by the Prime Minister approved the establishment of the Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0 (Startup India FoF 2.0). The Fund has been launched under the Startup India initiative to promote innovation and entrepreneurship across the country. It aims to accelerate the next phase of India's startup ecosystem by mobilising long-term domestic capital, strengthening the venture capital framework, and supporting innovation-led enterprises. The scheme adopts a targeted and segmented funding approach to support deep-tech and technology-driven innovative manufacturing sectors that require patient and long-term capital investment.

128. The new squat lobster species named *Leiogalathea samudragiri* was discovered near Lakshadweep under which government initiative?

- [A] National Fisheries Policy
- [B] Deep Ocean Mission
- [C] Blue Revolution Scheme
- [D] Sagarmala Programme

Answer: Deep Ocean Mission

Researchers discovered a new species of squat lobster named *Leiogalathea samudragiri* near Minicoy in the Lakshadweep archipelago. It was found at a depth of 360 metres below the sea surface. The discovery happened during a research cruise under India's Deep Ocean Mission, also called the Samudrayaan program. It has smooth and continuous ridges on the top of its shell, unlike related species with broken ridges. Squat lobsters are marine crustaceans, related to hermit and porcelain crabs.

129. Where was African Union (AU) Summit 2026 held?

- [A] Algeria
- [B] Botswana
- [C] Ethiopia
- [D] Namibia

**Answer: Ethiopia**

The 39th Ordinary Session of the Assembly of the African Union (AU) Summit 2026 was held at the African Union Headquarters in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia. The summit took place on February 14-15, 2026, focusing on "Ensuring the sustainable availability of safe water and sanitation systems". The Assembly is the highest decision-making body with heads of state and government. The Executive Council of foreign ministers handles policy matters. The African Union Commission implements decisions. The Peace and Security Council maintains peace and security.

130. India's first National Cow Culture Museum has been established in which city of Uttar Pradesh?

- [A] Varanasi
- [B] Mathura
- [C] Gorakhpur
- [D] Ayodhya

Answer: Mathura

India's first national Cow Culture Museum has been set up by Uttar Pradesh Braj Teerth Vikas Parishad in Mathura. It will be built on Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya Veterinary Science University campus and land has been selected. The museum will highlight religious, cultural, spiritual and scientific importance of cows. Around 100 digital and symbolic models of major and endangered cattle breeds will be displayed. The project promotes cow conservation, cow-based economy and scientific standards under state government guidance.

131. Which city is the venue of India Artificial Intelligence Impact Summit 2026?

- [A] Chennai
- [B] Mumbai
- [C] Bengaluru
- [D] New Delhi

Answer: New Delhi

India Artificial Intelligence Impact Summit 2026 started on 16 February in New Delhi for five days. It is the first global Artificial Intelligence summit hosted in the Global South. More than 100 countries are invited and more than two lakh participants registered online. Leaders from 20 nations including France, Brazil, Spain, Switzerland, Netherlands, United Arab Emirates, Mauritius, Sri Lanka, Seychelles and Bhutan are attending. United Nations Secretary General and delegates from 45 plus countries are participating. The Summit is guided by three pillars called Sutras: People, Planet and Progress.

132. The International Shivratri Festival 2026 is primarily celebrated in which district of Himachal Pradesh?

- [A] Mandi
- [B] Kangra
- [C] Chamba
- [D] Kullu

**Answer: Mandi**

Seven day International Shivratri Festival of Mandi district in Himachal Pradesh has begun and will continue till 21 February 2026. More than 216 palanquins of local deities have been invited to stay in Mandi during the week. The festival started with worship and first Jaleb ceremony at Shri Raj Madhav Rai Temple. The grand procession includes local deities, Gurus, folk artists and thousands of devotees. International Cultural Parade on 20 February will feature troupes from France, United States, Nigeria, Tanzania, Tajikistan and Sri Lanka. The festival showcases Mandi Dev culture, folk traditions and global cultural exchange.

133. Tamla Du Festival is celebrated by which tribal community of Arunachal Pradesh?

- [A] Nyishi
- [B] Adi
- [C] Apatani
- [D] Mishmi

Answer: Mishmi

Tamla Du Festival of Tawran also called Digaru Mishmi and Kaman also called Miju Mishmi community is celebrated in Arunachal Pradesh. The festival is dedicated to Lord Jabmalo and worship of nature for good health, good harvest and protection from natural disasters. It reflects deep respect for faith, environment and traditional values of the Mishmi community.

134. Piton de la Fournaise volcano, that was recently seen in news, is located in which ocean?

- [A] Pacific Ocean
- [B] Atlantic Ocean
- [C] Arctic Ocean
- [D] Indian Ocean

Answer: Indian Ocean

Piton de la Fournaise, located on the east-southeastern part of Réunion Island in the western Indian Ocean, has erupted for the second time this year. It is a massive basaltic shield volcano, formed by successive lava flows that create broad, gently sloping sides. The volcano is regarded as one of the most active volcanoes in the world due to its frequent eruptions. Its eruptions are typically short-lived and usually begin with spectacular lava fountains, followed by the outpouring of large lava flows.

135. Khorramshahr-4 ballistic missile is developed by which country?

- [A] Iran
- [B] Israel
- [C] Russia
- [D] Iraq

Answer: Iran

Iran recently released dramatic footage of its Khorramshahr-4 ballistic missile amid rising tensions with the United States of America (USA). The Khorramshahr-4, also called the Kheibar missile, is a medium-range ballistic missile (MRBM). It is developed by the Iranian



state-owned defence company Aerospace Industries Organization (AIO). The missile uses liquid fuel for propulsion. It has an operational range of around 2,000 kilometers. The missile travels faster than the speed of sound. It is considered one of Iran's most powerful medium-range missiles.

136. A new species of Diplura named *Lepidocampa sikkimensis* has been discovered in which region of India?

- [A] Chotanagpur plateau
- [B] Western Ghats
- [C] Eastern Himalayas
- [D] Eastern Ghats

Answer: Eastern Himalayas

Scientists from the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) discovered a new species of Diplura named *Lepidocampa sikkimensis* in the eastern Himalayas. The species was found in Ravangla, Sikkim. Diplura are small, wingless, soil-dwelling arthropods. This is the first time an Indian research team described a species in this primitive hexapod group. The study provides the first DNA barcode data globally for an Indian *Lepidocampa* species.

137. Tulbul Navigation Barrage Project, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state/UT?

- [A] Uttarakhand
- [B] Jammu and Kashmir
- [C] Himachal Pradesh
- [D] Ladakh

Answer: Jammu and Kashmir

The Jammu & Kashmir (J&K) government is considering diverting water from the Ravi River in Punjab to the Jammu region. This move comes amid the suspension of the Indus Waters Treaty (IWT) between India and Pakistan. J&K is also pushing to revive the Tulbul Navigation Barrage Project, also called the Wular Barrage. The barrage is a navigation lock-cum-control structure at the outlet of Wular Lake in J&K. It was designed to facilitate navigation on the Jhelum River during lean winter months. The project regulates Wular Lake water to maintain minimum river draft up to Baramulla in winter.

138. INS Tarangini, that was arrived in Visakhapatnam for MILAN exercise, is primarily classified as which type of ship?

- [A] Aircraft carrier
- [B] Submarine
- [C] Sail Training Ship (STS)
- [D] Destroyer

Answer: Sail Training Ship (STS)

The sail training ship (STS) INS Tarangini arrived in Visakhapatnam for the International Fleet Review (IFR) and MILAN exercise starting February 18. INS Tarangini is the Indian Navy's first sail training ship. It became the first Indian naval ship to circumnavigate the globe in 2003-2004. Its primary role is to instill courage, camaraderie, and endurance in



officer cadets starting a naval career. The ship provides hands-on training in sailing, setting and furling sails, watch-keeping, and sail manoeuvres.

139. Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) functions under which nodal Ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Consumer Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Food Processing Industries
- [C] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- [D] Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Answer: Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

The Supreme Court of India has directed the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) to consider mandatory front-of-package warning labels (FOPL) on packaged foods high in sugar, salt, and saturated fat. FSSAI was established under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006. It functions under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India. FSSAI is responsible for setting food standards and regulating manufacture, storage, distribution, sale, and import of food. It ensures the availability of safe and wholesome food for human consumption.

140. Lake Michigan, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] United States
- [B] Russia
- [C] United Kingdom
- [D] Australia

Answer: United States

The remains of the luxury steamer Lac La Belle have been discovered at the bottom of Lake Michigan over 150 years after it sank in a storm. Lake Michigan is the third largest of the five Great Lakes of North America. It is the only Great Lake entirely within the United States. By surface area, it is the fourth largest freshwater lake and the fifth largest lake in the world. The lake connects to Lake Huron through the Straits of Mackinac.

141. Which country conducted its first air transport of a micro nuclear reactor using a C-17 military aircraft?

- [A] United States
- [B] Israel
- [C] Germany
- [D] Russia

Answer: United States

The United States of America (USA) conducted its first air transport of a micro nuclear reactor using a C-17 military aircraft. The Departments of Energy (DOE) and Defense (DOD) transported the Ward microreactor developed by Valar Atomics from California to Hill Air Force Base without nuclear fuel. This shows rapid nuclear deployment capability for military and civilian use. The reactor can generate up to 5 megawatts, enough for about 5,000 homes. It will start at 100 kilowatts and gradually scale to full capacity.

142. The Bhavya Bharat Bhushan Award was launched by which spiritual leader?

- [A] Sri Sri Ravi Shankar



- [B] Baba Ramdev
- [C] Sadhguru Jaggi Vasudev
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Sadhguru Jaggi Vasudev

Spiritual leader Sadhguru Jaggi Vasudev launched the Bhavya Bharat Bhushan Award. The award honours excellence in national security, business, arts and entertainment, sports, community welfare, science and technology, and literature and academia. It was presented during Mahashivaratri celebrations in the presence of Defence Minister Rajnath Singh. Violinist N. Rajam received the honour and called it a blessing. Former Indian Space Research Organisation Chairman S. Kiran Kumar said the award represents ISRO's contribution to India's space progress. The award aims to recognise individuals whose work significantly contributes to national growth and public well-being.

143. Which state has approved India's first comprehensive graphene policy?

- [A] Odisha
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Kerala

Kerala approved India's first comprehensive graphene policy to become a global hub for research, development, and production of graphene. The Union Cabinet approved Grefine Park as the first major step. The state offers a 50% subsidy on lease payments for manufacturing units in government parks. Plans include a graphene industrial park in Palakkad and a Digital Innovation Centre with ₹200 crore investment. The policy promotes collaboration with University of Oxford and University of Manchester.

144. The 'Bharat VISTAAR' scheme was launched from which state by Union Minister for Agriculture?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Haryana
- [C] Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Rajasthan

Answer: Rajasthan

Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, and Rural Development, Shivraj Singh Chouhan launched the Bharat VISTAAR scheme in Jaipur, Rajasthan. The scheme is an Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based initiative by the Department of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare. Farmers can dial 155261 to get instant solutions, scheme details, and mandi prices. A Farmer Identity Card (ID) will store complete farmer data. Schemes like Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) and Soil Health Card are integrated. The goal is to enhance production, provide one-platform information, and promote Viksit Kisan for Viksit Bharat 2047.

145. The 'Bee Corridor' initiative has been launched by which organization?

- [A] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change



- [B] National Highways Authority of India
- [C] National Biodiversity Authority
- [D] Indian Council of Agricultural Research

Answer: National Highways Authority of India

The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) launched a first-of-its-kind 'Bee Corridor' initiative along National Highways. The project will create continuous stretches of bee-friendly flowering trees and plants to ensure year-round nectar and pollen. It shifts focus from ornamental to ecological plantations for pollinator conservation. Native species like Neem, Karanj, Mahua, Palash, Bottle Brush, Jamun, and Siris will be planted. Clusters will be developed every 500 meters to 1 kilometer, matching bee foraging distance. At least three corridors will be developed in 2026-27. Around 40 lakh trees will be planted, with 60% under Bee Corridor, promoting sustainable highway development.

146. Which institution launched AI-Preneurs of India, a flagship coffee table book, at India AI Impact Summit 2026?

- [A] Reserve Bank of India
- [B] Atal Innovation Mission under NITI Aayog
- [C] National Association of Software and Service Companies (NASSCOM)
- [D] Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Answer: Atal Innovation Mission under NITI Aayog

The Atal Innovation Mission (AIM) under NITI Aayog launched AI-Preneurs of India, a coffee table book on 45 Artificial Intelligence (AI) startups. It was unveiled at the India AI Impact Summit at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. This is the 7th edition of AIM's Innovations For You series. Startups featured work in healthcare, education, sustainability, mobility, deep tech, and social impact. The book highlights purpose-driven, inclusive, and ethical AI innovation. It reflects support from Atal Incubation Centres (AICs) across India. The initiative positions India as a global contributor in responsible AI development.

147. Where was 23rd BioAsia 2026 international summit held?

- [A] Hyderabad
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Bengaluru
- [D] Mumbai

Answer: Hyderabad

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy inaugurated the 23rd BioAsia 2026 international summit in Hyderabad. The two-day event is held at Hyderabad International Convention Centre (HICC). The theme for 2026 is "TechBio Unleashed – Artificial Intelligence (AI), Automation, and Revolutionary Changes in Life Sciences." The summit highlights India's rise as a global TechBio innovation hub. It features global scientists, industry leaders, and life sciences organisations.

148. Which state has officially declared 948 trees as "living heritage" trees?

- [A] Uttar Pradesh
- [B] Uttarakhand



[C] Punjab

[D] Haryana

Answer: Uttar Pradesh

As of February 2026, the Uttar Pradesh government has officially declared 948 trees as "living heritage" trees, becoming the first state in India to formally institutionalize the protection of ancient trees. This initiative is part of a broader heritage tree conservation and adoption programme aimed at safeguarding trees that have silently witnessed generations of social and cultural change.

149. Shahpur Kandi Dam project, that was recently seen in news, is located on which river?

[A] Chenab

[B] Ravi

[C] Beas

[D] Godavari

Answer: Ravi

India plans to stop surplus water of the Ravi River from flowing into Pakistan by completing the Shahpur Kandi Dam. The Shahpur Kandi Dam project is located on the Ravi River in Pathankot district of Punjab, near the Jammu and Kashmir-Punjab border. It is built downstream of the Ranjit Sagar Dam, which already stores river water. Water released from Ranjit Sagar Dam will be used in Shahpur Kandi Dam to generate electricity. The project was declared a National Project in 2008. Punjab government funds 80 percent of the cost, while the Central Government provides 20 percent.

150. Lake Victoria, that was recently seen in news, is the largest lake of which continent?

[A] Asia

[B] Africa

[C] Europe

[D] Australia

Answer: Africa

Lake Victoria's water has turned green due to severe ecological damage, mainly from algal blooms. Lake Victoria is the largest lake in Africa. It lies mainly in Tanzania and Uganda and also borders Kenya. It is known as Victoria Nyanza in Kenya, Nalubaale in Uganda, and Ukerewe in Tanzania. It is crossed by the Equator. It is the second-largest freshwater lake in the world after Lake Superior in North America.

151. Which state started six hornbill restaurants in Udanti Sitanadi Tiger Reserve to support the Malabar Pied Hornbill?

[A] Maharashtra

[B] Kerala

[C] Chhattisgarh

[D] Odisha

Answer: Chhattisgarh

Chhattisgarh Forest Department started six hornbill restaurants in Udanti Sitanadi Tiger Reserve to support the Malabar Pied Hornbill and promote natural forest growth. Malabar



Pied Hornbill, scientifically called *Anthracoceros coronatus*, belongs to the hornbill family. It is a medium-sized bird with black and white feathers and a large casque on its beak. It lives in evergreen and moist deciduous forests, often near human settlements. It is found in Western Ghats, north-eastern Himalayan foothills, Satpuda Hills, Nepal and Sri Lanka. It is listed as Near Threatened by International Union for Conservation of Nature due to habitat loss.

152. Which day is observed as Global Tourism Resilience Day annually?

- [A] February 15
- [B] February 16
- [C] February 17
- [D] February 18

Answer: February 17

Global Tourism Resilience Day is observed every year on February 17 to highlight the tourism sector's resilience and adaptability. On 17 February 2023, the world observed the first Global Tourism Resilience Day, created by a United Nations resolution led by Jamaica, promoting tourism that "bounces forward." Tourism resilience focuses on strong systems, diversification and crisis-readiness, not just tourist numbers or foreign exchange earnings. India treats tourism as national infrastructure—economic, ecological and cultural—to prevent collapse during crises. Dekho Apna Desh promotes domestic travel across regions and seasons, reducing dependence on international visitors.

153. The 17th Tribal Youth Exchange Programme is a flagship initiative of which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Tribal Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
- [C] Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- [D] Ministry of Culture

Answer: Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

The 17th Tribal Youth Exchange Programme was held in Kancheepuram district of Tamil Nadu. It is a flagship initiative of the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports in coordination with the Ministry of Home Affairs. Around 200 tribal youth from Left Wing Extremism-affected districts of Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand and Maharashtra participated in the event. The week-long camp promotes national integration and cultural understanding.

154. Which Indian city is the host of Earthshot Prize 2026?

- [A] Kolkata
- [B] Hyderabad
- [C] Chennai
- [D] Mumbai

Answer: Mumbai

Mumbai will host the Earthshot Prize 2026 in November, marking the first time the award comes to India. The Earthshot Prize was founded in 2020 by Prince William of Britain to promote global action to protect the planet. The announcement was made during Mumbai Climate Week. The award will honour 15 innovative environmental solutions. The



five categories are Protect and Restore Nature, Clean Our Air, Revive Our Oceans, Build a Waste-Free World and Fix Our Climate.

155. Who has been appointed as State Election Commissioner of Jammu and Kashmir by Lieutenant Governor in February 2026?

- [A] Girish Chandra
- [B] Shantmanu
- [C] R. N. Ravi
- [D] Jagat Prakash Nadda

Answer: Shantmanu

Lieutenant Governor of Jammu and Kashmir Manoj Sinha appointed Shantmanu, a retired Indian Administrative Service officer, as State Election Commissioner. The appointment is for the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir. It was made under sub-section 3 of Section 36 of the Jammu and Kashmir Panchayati Raj Act, 1989. He will hold office for five years or until he attains 70 years of age, whichever is earlier. The appointment will be effective from the date he assumes charge. The government will separately notify the detailed terms and conditions of his service.

156. Which state government launched the Provincialisation Management System (PMS) portal at Lok Sewa Bhawan in February 2026?

- [A] Tripura
- [B] Assam
- [C] Manipur
- [D] Mizoram

Answer: Assam

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma launched the Provincialisation Management System portal at Lok Sewa Bhawan. The portal will process applications of venture schools, colleges and their staff under the Assam Education Act, 2017, amended in 2025. It creates a centralised database to ensure transparency and remove irregularities in provincialisation. More than 50,000 teachers were provincialised since 2011, and this is the third and most comprehensive phase. It covers Lower Primary, Upper Primary, Middle English, high schools, higher secondary schools and degree colleges. Gurudakshina scheme offers financial support to ineligible applicants.

157. Which ministry has launched open-source VoicERA Voice AI Stack on BHASHINI infrastructure at India AI Impact Summit 2026?

- [A] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [B] Ministry of Communications
- [C] Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
- [D] Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Answer: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology launched VoicERA at India Artificial Intelligence Impact Summit 2026. VoicERA is an open-source, end-to-end Voice Artificial Intelligence stack to strengthen Digital Public Infrastructure. It was launched by Digital



India BHASHINI Division under Digital India Corporation. It is built with EkStep Foundation, International Institute of Information Technology Bengaluru and Artificial Intelligence for Bharat. It runs on BHASHINI National Language Infrastructure as a multilingual voice execution layer.

158. Which country is the host of 52nd G7 Summit 2026?

- [A] Italy
- [B] Germany
- [C] France
- [D] Japan

Answer: France

French President Emmanuel Macron invited the Prime Minister of India to attend the 52nd G7 Summit 2026 in France. The G7 Summit 2026 is the annual meeting of leaders of seven advanced democracies to discuss global economy, security, climate change and geopolitical issues. France will host the summit at Évian in 2026. The Group of Seven is an informal forum of major industrialised democracies. The members of G7 are United States, United Kingdom, Canada, France, Germany, Italy and Japan. The forum coordinates policies to address global economic and political challenges.

159. The Strait of Hormuz, that was recently seen in news, is located between which two regions?

- [A] Saudi Arabia and Yemen
- [B] USA and Russia
- [C] Iran and the Arabian Peninsula
- [D] South Korea and Japan

Answer: Iran and the Arabian Peninsula

Naval forces of Iran, Russia and China will conduct a joint military exercise near the Strait of Hormuz. The Strait of Hormuz is a narrow waterway between Iran and the Arabian Peninsula, mainly the United Arab Emirates and Musandam in Oman. The Gulf of Oman lies to the east and the Persian Gulf lies to the west. It is the only sea route connecting the oil-rich Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea. Iran is on the north coast and the United Arab Emirates is on the south coast.

160. Operation Kayakalp was launched by which state government to improve infrastructure in government primary and upper primary schools?

- [A] Madhya Pradesh
- [B] Uttar Pradesh
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Uttar Pradesh

Operation Kayakalp was launched in 2018 by the Uttar Pradesh Government to improve infrastructure in government primary and upper primary schools. It addressed poor facilities like toilets, drinking water, boundary walls, furniture and electricity, which affected attendance and learning. The scheme follows a 19-point infrastructure standard for safe and child-friendly schools. Around 1.26 lakh schools upgraded, benefiting nearly 2



crore students with improved attendance and reduced dropouts.

161. India's first government-supported National Biobank for Lysosomal Storage Disorders (LSDs) was launched in which state?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Haryana
- [D] Rajasthan

Answer: Gujarat

India's first government-supported National Biobank for Lysosomal Storage Disorders (LSDs) was launched in February 2026 at the Foundation for Research in Genetics and Endocrinology (FRIGE) in Ahmedabad, Gujarat. It is funded by the Department of Biotechnology (DBT). This facility stores biological samples and data from 530 patients across 15 states to advance research, develop affordable diagnostic tools, and improve treatment for rare metabolic disorders.

162. What is 'Galathea balasubramaniani' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] A new species of Crab
- [B] Invasive weed
- [C] Newly discovered species of Fish
- [D] Traditional medicine

Answer: A new species of Crab

Researchers discovered a new tiny crab species named *Galathea balasubramaniani* from coral reefs of Agatti in Lakshadweep Islands. It belongs to genus *Galathea*, a group of small reef-dwelling anomuran crabs called squat lobsters. These crabs look like tiny lobsters and hide in coral and rocky crevices. It measures only about 3 millimetres, making it one of the smallest reef crabs in the region. It plays a key ecological role by recycling organic matter and serving as food for fish and other marine life.

163. CHaracterising ExOPlanet Satellite (CHEOPS) is a mission of which space agency?

- [A] National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)
- [B] Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- [C] European Space Agency (ESA)
- [D] Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)

Answer: European Space Agency (ESA)

The CHaracterising ExOPlanet Satellite (CHEOPS) of the European Space Agency has discovered a four-planet system around a nearby star. The observation showed that the outermost planet in this system is small and rocky in nature. The CHaracterising ExOPlanet Satellite (CHEOPS) is a space mission developed and operated by the European Space Agency to study exoplanets orbiting bright, nearby stars. It is the first mission specifically designed to observe stars that are already known to host exoplanets and to measure their sizes with very high precision as the planets transit across their host stars.

164. Salem, which is known as the hub of India's sago and starch industry, is located in which state?



- [A] Punjab
- [B] Haryana
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Tamil Nadu

Answer: Tamil Nadu

Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry facilitated export of 0.5 metric tonne of Geographical Indication tagged Salem Sago from Tamil Nadu to Canada. This was the first direct export by Geographical Indication Authorised User SAGOSERVE after receiving Geographical Indication tag in March 2023. Tamil Nadu is the largest producer of tapioca sago, also called sabudhana, and Salem is the hub of sago and starch industry.

165. NIGRANI App was launched under which scheme to monitor infrastructure projects in minority concentrated areas?

- [A] Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP)
- [B] National Minorities Development and Finance Corporation (NMDFC)
- [C] Pradhan Mantri Vikas Initiative for Minority Communities (PMVIKAS)
- [D] Pradhan Mantri Jan Vikas Karyakram (PMJVK)

Answer: Pradhan Mantri Jan Vikas Karyakram (PMJVK)

Union Minority Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju, launched NIGRANI App, Haj Wrist Band and Artificial Intelligence chatbots during Chintan Shivir at Nalanda University. The event was organised by Ministry of Minority Affairs to focus on infrastructure and socio economic empowerment of minorities. NIGRANI App was launched under Pradhan Mantri Jan Vikas Karyakram to monitor infrastructure projects in minority concentrated areas. The app ensures transparency, real time monitoring and better implementation. Haj Wrist Band and Artificial Intelligence chatbots aim to improve Haj management and service delivery.

166. Who is the author of the book titled "The Sage who Reimagined Hinduism: The Life, Lessons and Legacy of Sree Narayana Guru"?

- [A] S. Jaishankar
- [B] Shashi Tharoor
- [C] Ramachandra Guha
- [D] Amish Tripathi

Answer: Shashi Tharoor

Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan released the book The Sage who Reimagined Hinduism The Life Lessons and Legacy of Sree Narayana Guru in New Delhi. The book is authored by Shashi Tharoor. It highlights life and teachings of Sree Narayana Guru who worked against caste discrimination and social injustice.

167. Which city has been selected for the establishment of a National Centre of Excellence for Skilling in Aeronautics and Defence?

- [A] Chennai
- [B] Kanpur
- [C] Hyderabad



[D] Bengaluru

Answer: Kanpur

Government announced National Centre of Excellence for Skilling in Aeronautics and Defence at National Skill Training Institute Kanpur. Centre will be set up with Government of France under Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded Industrial Training Institutes scheme. Initiative will strengthen India France strategic partnership and align Indian skills with global standards in advanced manufacturing sectors.

168. Which state has been declared free from Naxal activities after the surrender of the last armed Maoist, Suresh Koda, in February 2026?

[A] Bihar

[B] Jharkhand

[C] Odisha

[D] Chhattisgarh

Answer: Bihar

Bihar has been declared free from Naxal activities after surrender of last armed Maoist Suresh Koda in Munger. Deputy Inspector General Rakesh Kumar said no armed Naxalite squad is active in 23 previously affected districts. District Magistrate stated that surrender and rehabilitation benefits will be given under Central Government policy. In 2012, 23 districts were Naxal affected and influence was high in 1970s especially in central Bihar. Due to joint efforts of Centre and State, no Naxal incident was reported in 2025 and 220 Naxalites were arrested.

169. 'Atal Canteen' scheme was launched by which state/UT government?

[A] Haryana

[B] Delhi

[C] Punjab

[D] Jammu and Kashmir

Answer: Delhi

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated 25 new Atal Canteens. With this, total 71 Atal Canteens are now operational in the city. On 25 December 2025, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched the Atal Canteen Scheme. The canteens provide clean and nutritious meals at affordable prices. Government plans to expand the number to 100 soon. The scheme supports labourers, street vendors, construction workers and rickshaw pullers by ensuring food security, dignity and social inclusion.

170. World Day of Social Justice is observed annually on which day?

[A] February 17

[B] February 18

[C] February 19

[D] February 20

Answer: February 20



World Day of Social Justice is observed annually on 20 February to highlight the need to promote social justice, equality, inclusion, and human dignity across societies. The day was designated by the United Nations on 26 November 2007 to address deep-rooted global challenges such as poverty, unemployment, social exclusion, and inequality. It aims to promote equal opportunities for all and encourage policies that ensure fair access to resources and rights. The 2026 theme, "Renewed Commitment to Social Development and Social Justice," emphasises inclusive policymaking and targeted actions to reduce social and economic disparities worldwide.

171. Project Vault was unveiled by which country?

- [A] France
- [B] United States
- [C] Russia
- [D] Germany

Answer: United States

The United States has unveiled Project Vault, an independently governed and operated public-private partnership. The initiative aims to establish a strategic domestic reserve of critical minerals to strengthen supply chain security in the U.S. The partnership is supported by \$10 billion in financing from the Export-Import Bank of the United States (EXIM), along with an additional \$2 billion in private sector funding. Project Vault represents a whole-of-government approach to reduce reliance on foreign-controlled supply chains for essential minerals.

172. The global AI-for-Energy Mission was launched by which organisation at the India AI Impact Summit 2026?

- [A] International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA)
- [B] World Bank
- [C] International Solar Alliance (ISA)
- [D] United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)

Answer: International Solar Alliance (ISA)

The International Solar Alliance (ISA) launched a global AI-for-Energy mission at the India AI Impact Summit in New Delhi to accelerate clean energy adoption across its 120+ member countries. The AI-for-Energy mission is a strategic international initiative aimed at integrating Artificial Intelligence (AI) into the clean energy infrastructure of developing and emerging economies. It leverages the India Energy Stack, a digital public infrastructure model, to modernize electricity grids and promote decentralized power systems.

173. The Dibang Multipurpose Project is being constructed in which state?

- [A] Himachal Pradesh
- [B] Sikkim
- [C] Arunachal Pradesh
- [D] Assam

Answer: Arunachal Pradesh



The under-construction Dibang Multipurpose Project in Arunachal Pradesh recently achieved a major milestone with the successful daylighting of Diversion Tunnel-3 (DT-3). The project is being developed on the Dibang River, a tributary of the Brahmaputra River, and is designed as a flood control-cum-hydroelectric power project. With an installed capacity of 2,880 MW, it will become India's largest hydropower facility. The project is being executed by National Hydroelectric Power Corporation (NHPC). It is conceived as an energy storage project with flood moderation as a key objective in addition to electricity generation.

174. A new meat-eating dinosaur named Spinosaurus mirabilis was discovered in which desert?

- [A] Gobi Desert
- [B] Atacama Desert
- [C] Sahara Desert
- [D] Kalahari Desert

Answer: Sahara Desert

A new meat-eating dinosaur named Spinosaurus mirabilis was discovered in the Sahara Desert. Its fossils were found in Jengueb area of Niger in the central Sahara. It lived about 95 million years ago in a forested inland region with rivers. It is the second known species of Spinosaurus. The first species, Spinosaurus aegyptiacus, was discovered in 1915 in Egypt.

175. What is the primary objective of Vibrant Villages Programme-II?

- [A] Promote industrial corridors in border areas
- [B] Develop smart cities in border districts
- [C] Ensure comprehensive development of border villages
- [D] Promote tourism in coastal areas

Answer: Ensure comprehensive development of border villages

The Union Home Minister will launch Vibrant Villages Programme-II in Cachar district of Assam. It is a Central Sector Scheme with 100 percent funding by the Central Government. It aims at comprehensive and sustainable development of border villages through saturation and convergence approach. Objective is to improve living conditions, create livelihood opportunities, ensure safe borders and reduce trans-border crime. It covers strategic villages in Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Bihar, Gujarat, Jammu and Kashmir, Ladakh, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Punjab, Rajasthan, Sikkim, Tripura, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh and West Bengal. It excludes northern border areas already covered under VVP-I.

176. Nandhaur Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?

- [A] Himachal Pradesh
- [B] Uttarakhand
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Uttarakhand

Recently, smooth-coated otters were officially recorded for the first time in Nandhaur



Wildlife Sanctuary by the Uttarakhand Forest Department. Nandhaur Wildlife Sanctuary is located in Uttarakhand. It lies in the Terai Arc Landscape and forms part of the Shivalik Elephant Reserve. It connects the landscapes of Jim Corbett National Park and Rajaji National Park in the west with Pilibhit-Dudwa and the Terai region of Nepal in the east.

177. The policy report titled "Revitalizing Apprenticeship Ecosystem" was released by which institution?

- [A] Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship
- [B] NITI Aayog
- [C] National Skill Development Corporation
- [D] Reserve Bank of India

Answer: NITI Aayog

NITI Aayog launched a report titled "Revitalizing Apprenticeship Ecosystem: Insights, Challenges, Recommendations and Best Practices." The report analyses India's apprenticeship system and suggests reforms to strengthen skilling and employment. It gives 20 action-oriented recommendations with clear responsibilities and performance metrics. Recommendations are grouped under five pillars including policy reforms, regulatory strengthening, state-level action, industry engagement and apprentice support. It aligns apprenticeship growth with Viksit Bharat 2047 and global best practices to build a skilled and competitive workforce.

178. International Mother Language Day is observed every year on which day?

- [A] February 19
- [B] February 20
- [C] February 21
- [D] February 22

Answer: February 21

International Mother Language Day is observed every year on 21 February to promote linguistic diversity and multilingual education. It highlights the need to protect and preserve mother tongues across the world. In 2026, it is marked under the theme "Youth voices on multilingual education." The day is observed by UNESCO. It aligns with the International Decade of Indigenous Languages to safeguard indigenous and endangered languages. The day encourages inclusion, cultural identity and equal learning opportunities through native languages.

179. The Gaganyaan Drogue Parachute was jointly developed by which organizations?

- [A] National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) and Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- [B] European Space Agency (ESA) and Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- [C] Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- [D] Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)

Answer: Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and Defence Research and Development

**Organisation (DRDO)**

The Defence Research and Development Organisation conducted a qualification-level load test of the Gaganyaan drogue parachute at the Rail Track Rocket Sled facility in Chandigarh. This marks a major milestone in India's human spaceflight mission, Gaganyaan. The drogue parachute is a key part of the Crew Module deceleration system. It deploys during atmospheric re-entry to stabilize the module and reduce speed before the main parachutes open. It was jointly developed by the Indian Space Research Organisation and the Defence Research and Development Organisation.

180. Shalimar Wheat-3 (SW-3) and Shalimar Wheat-4 (SW-4) have been developed by which agricultural university?

[A] Punjab Agricultural University

[B] Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences and Technology (SKUAST-K)

[C] Maharana Pratap University of Agriculture & Technology, Udaipur

[D] Anand Agricultural University, Gujarat

Answer: Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences and Technology (SKUAST-K)

Scientists at Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences and Technology, Kashmir developed two early-maturing Shalimar Wheat varieties to strengthen the rice-wheat cropping system. Shalimar Wheat includes Shalimar Wheat-4, which matures by the last week of May, and Shalimar Wheat-3, which matures by the first week of June. These varieties are specially bred for Kashmir's climate and are suitable for mid-altitude areas up to about 1,850 metres. Early maturity allows timely harvesting of wheat and smooth transplantation of paddy. They help maintain proper crop rotation without delays in rice cultivation. The varieties show resistance to yellow rust, a major fungal disease in the region.

181. Bio-AI Mulankur hubs have been announced by which ministry?

[A] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

[B] Ministry of Science and Technology

[C] Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare

[D] Ministry of Finance

Answer: Ministry of Science and Technology

Ministry of Science and Technology announced the establishment of Bio-AI Mulankur hubs to strengthen integration of biotechnology and Artificial Intelligence. Aim is to create integrated closed-loop research platforms where Artificial Intelligence based predictions are tested and validated in laboratories within the same system. This will reduce gap between computational research and experimental results. Initiative is aligned with BioE3 Policy, which stands for Biotechnology for Environment, Economy and Employment. It aims to promote sustainable development, economic growth and job creation through biotechnology. Implementing agencies are Department of Biotechnology and Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council.

182. What is the IUCN conservation status of 'Lion-tailed macaque' that was recently seen in news?

[A] Endangered



- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Near threatened

Answer: Endangered

Recent study shows lion-tailed macaque population is stable and increasing in some plantation-dominated areas. Lion-tailed macaque is an endemic primate of Western Ghats. International Union for Conservation of Nature status is Endangered. It is called bearded monkey due to grey mane and has lion-like tail. It is found in evergreen rainforests of southern Western Ghats in Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Karnataka. Two genetically distinct groups exist on either side of Palghat Gap.

183. The Offshore Wind Taskforce between India and the United Kingdom was launched under which framework?

- [A] India-UK Free Trade Agreement
- [B] India-UK Vision 2035
- [C] International Solar Alliance
- [D] G20 Energy Ministers' Meeting

Answer: India-UK Vision 2035

India and the United Kingdom launched the Offshore Wind Taskforce under India-UK Vision 2035 and the Fourth Energy Dialogue. It aims to accelerate India's offshore wind sector through coordinated policy, infrastructure and financing support. The partnership combines the UK's mature offshore wind ecosystem with India's 71 GW offshore wind potential and large domestic market. The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) is the nodal ministry. The National Institute of Wind Energy (NIWE) will conduct resource assessment

184. The Indian Army's Southern Command conducted Exercise Vajra Ghaat in which state?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Rajasthan
- [C] Punjab
- [D] Uttarakhand

Answer: Rajasthan

The Indian Army's Southern Command conducted Exercise Vajra Ghaat at Pokhran Field Firing Range in Jaisalmer district, Rajasthan. The exercise focused on testing the K9 Vajra self-propelled artillery gun system in desert warfare conditions of the Thar Desert. It was spearheaded by the White Tiger Division. The objective is to validate refined Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) for better survivability and operational effectiveness. The drill demonstrated swift deployment of heavy artillery in harsh terrain. K9 Vajra carried out high-intensity, precise fire missions.

185. Which startup company launched the sovereign AI models 'Sarvam 30B' and 'Sarvam 105B'?

- [A] Sarvam AI
- [B] Zoho AI Labs
- [C] Haptik



[D] Ola Krutrim

Answer: Sarvam AI

Sarvam AI, a Bengaluru-based startup, unveiled its flagship sovereign Artificial Intelligence models Sarvam 30B and Sarvam 105B at the IndiaAI Impact Summit 2026. These are considered India's first large-scale foundational Large Language Models (LLMs) developed domestically, marking a major step toward AI self-reliance. Both models are open-source, promoting transparency, innovation, and wider adoption by developers and institutions. The models are optimised for 22 Indian languages across 11 primary scripts, supporting linguistic diversity and digital inclusion.

186. Indira Gandhi Sukh Shiksha Yojana was launched by which state government?

[A] Himachal Pradesh

[B] Uttar Pradesh

[C] Uttarakhand

[D] Punjab

Answer: Himachal Pradesh

Himachal Pradesh expanded Indira Gandhi Sukh Shiksha Yojana to support daughters of widows pursuing higher education within and outside the state. Indira Gandhi Sukh Shiksha Yojana was launched by Himachal Pradesh government. Scheme earlier covered children of widows, destitute or divorced women and disabled parents up to 18 years. Now eligible daughters can receive benefits up to 27 years of age. Financial aid of Rs 3,000 per month for 10 months for professional courses in government institutions outside state.

187. Which country announced its withdrawal from the Ottawa Convention (Mine Ban Treaty) in February 2026?

[A] Finland

[B] Poland

[C] Hungary

[D] Romania

Answer: Poland

Poland announced withdrawal from the Ottawa Convention to allow quick deployment of Anti-Personnel Landmines (APLs) along its eastern borders if needed. The Ottawa Convention, also called the Mine Ban Treaty, bans use, production, stockpiling and transfer of APLs. Member countries must destroy stockpiled APLs within 4 years and clear planted mines within 10 years. Extension of up to 10 years can be requested for mine destruction. Countries must submit annual reports on stockpiles, mine locations and destruction progress. The treaty came into force on 1 March 1999 and has unlimited duration.

188. A new Cobra Lily species named *Arisaema siahaense* was recently discovered in which northeastern state?

[A] Assam

[B] Manipur



- [C] Mizoram
- [D] Nagaland

Answer: Mizoram

Researchers discovered a new Cobra Lily species named *Arisaema siahaense* in Siaha District of Mizoram, Northeast India. It is an evergreen herb growing up to 1.08 metre (about 3.5 feet) tall. Cobra Lilies are known for spathe shaped like a cobra hood. This species has an exceptionally long spadix appendix up to 21 centimetre with brownish-green hair-like bristles. It grows from a rounded tuber, not creeping rootstock, and has exactly three leaf segments.

189. Kolleru Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?

- [A] Andhra Pradesh
- [B] Tamil Nadu
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

New aquaculture tanks were reportedly dug inside Kolleru Wildlife Sanctuary after illegal tanks were earlier demolished following Supreme Court orders. Kolleru Wildlife Sanctuary is located in West Godavari and Krishna districts of Andhra Pradesh. It was established under the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972. It covers about 308 square kilometre of wetlands and marshes. It protects Kolleru Lake, declared a Ramsar Site of International Importance in 2002. Lake receives water from Budameru and Tammileru rivers and 67 drains linked to Krishna and Godavari river systems.

190. What is the name of the nationwide awareness campaign launched in February 2026 to promote the Skill India Digital Hub (SIDH)?

- [A] Kaushal Bharat Abhiyan
- [B] Digital Hunar Mission
- [C] Badhna Hai Toh Yahan Judna Hai
- [D] Skill Connect India

Answer: Badhna Hai Toh Yahan Judna Hai

Shri Jayant Chaudhary launched nationwide campaign “Badhna Hai Toh Yahan Judna Hai” at India AI Impact Summit 2026 to promote Skill India Digital Hub (SIDH). Actor Amitabh Bachchan joined as campaign ambassador to boost awareness and participation. SIDH is an integrated digital platform for skilling, employment and lifelong learning with over 1.5 crore registered candidates. It supports Viksit Bharat vision amid Artificial Intelligence (AI) and automation growth. Mobile-first and AI-enabled platform integrates government schemes and industry-ready courses.

191. Recently, which bird species became the first confirmed case of H5 avian influenza infection in an Australian territory?

- [A] Rainbow Lorikeet
- [B] Wedge-tailed Eagle
- [C] Gentoo Penguin



[D] Black Swan

Answer: Gentoo Penguin

Gentoo penguins became first bird species confirmed with H5 avian influenza in an Australian territory. It is closely related to Adélie penguin and Chinstrap penguin. It is found along Antarctic Peninsula, sub-Antarctic islands and Falkland Islands in Southern Hemisphere between 45° and 65° south latitude. It lives near shorelines for easy food access and nesting. It is fastest underwater swimmer among penguins. It is diurnal, social and breeds in colonies. International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) status is Least Concern.

192. The Tetanus and Diphtheria (Td) vaccine was recently launched at which institute?

[A] All India Institutes of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), New Delhi

[B] Central Research Institute, Kasauli

[C] National Institute of Virology, Pune

[D] Pasteur Institute of India, Coonoor

Answer: Central Research Institute, Kasauli

Health and Family Welfare Minister Jagat Prakash Nadda launched indigenous Tetanus and Diphtheria vaccine at Central Research Institute, Kasauli in Solan district, Himachal Pradesh. Vaccine supports vision of Atmanirbhar Bharat in health sector. India is known as Pharmacy of the World. Universal Immunization Programme (UIP) is world's largest immunization programme. Central Research Institute will supply 5.5 million vaccine doses by April 2026 to strengthen immunization coverage.

193. Which state is the host of National Divyangjan Cricket Sports Festival 2026?

[A] Madhya Pradesh

[B] Uttar Pradesh

[C] Rajasthan

[D] Gujarat

Answer: Madhya Pradesh

Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav inaugurated National Divyangjan Cricket Sports Festival 2026 in Bhopal. Theme is "Not Out @ 100" and 350 Divyang players from 25 states will play cricket continuously for 100 hours to create record. It is first event of its kind in the world with non-stop 100-hour cricket. Event is dedicated to birth centenary of social reformer Kushabhau Thakre. Festival will run day and night till 26 February. Divyang term reflects inner strength and willpower as highlighted by Prime Minister.

194. "Operation Trashi-I" is an anti-terror operation launched in which State/UT?

[A] Punjab

[B] Rajasthan

[C] Gujarat

[D] Jammu and Kashmir

Answer: Jammu and Kashmir

Three terrorists were killed in joint security operation "Trashi-I" in Kishtwar district of Jammu and Kashmir. Operation was launched on specific intelligence about presence of



three Pakistani terrorists in Passerkoot area of Chatroo belt. Terrorists hiding in mudhouse opened fire, leading to intense gunfight in difficult terrain. Joint teams of Army 11 Rashtriya Rifles, Jammu and Kashmir Police and Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) conducted operation. Contact was re-established around 11 AM and all three terrorists were neutralised. Two AK-47 rifles and other warlike materials were recovered.

195. Which state hosted first Soybean Festival to boost farmer empowerment?

- [A] Manipur
- [B] Arunachal Pradesh
- [C] Nagaland
- [D] Assam

Answer: Nagaland

Nagaland hosted first Soybean Festival at Agri Expo, Chümoukedima on 20–21 February with more than 200 farmers, scientists and officials. Event aimed to boost soybean cultivation and farmer empowerment. Experts from Nagaland University and Indian Council of Agricultural Research–National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources (ICAR-NBPGR), New Delhi promoted productivity and sustainable practices. Nagaland's average yield is 12.6 quintals per hectare. It is higher than national average of 11.79 quintals per hectare, showing strong growth potential.

196. World Peace and Understanding Day 2026 is observed on which day?

- [A] February 22
- [B] February 23
- [C] February 24
- [D] February 25

Answer: February 23

World Peace and Understanding Day 2026 is observed on 23 February 2026. It marks anniversary of first Rotary meeting held in Chicago in 1905. That meeting led to foundation of Rotary International, a global humanitarian organisation. The day is celebrated during World Understanding Month in February. It promotes service, ethical leadership and international cooperation. It highlights role of goodwill and dialogue in building harmony. It reminds that lasting peace needs justice, empathy and collective action at all levels of society.

197. Panama disease, which was recently in the news, primarily affects which crop?

- [A] Banana
- [B] Coconut
- [C] Sugarcane
- [D] Rubber

Answer: Banana

Scientists discovered a gene that may protect bananas from Panama disease. Panama disease is also called Fusarium wilt. It is caused by fungus *Fusarium oxysporum* f. sp. *cubense* living in soil for many years. It mainly affects Cavendish or G9 banana cultivar, most widely grown variety. Fungus infects through roots and blocks water and nutrient



transport. Due to severe impact, it is called banana cancer. Symptoms include yellowing of older leaves, turning brown and dry. Stem becomes dark brown and plant finally dies. Dead leaves hang around lower stem forming skirt-like structure.

198. PRASHAD Scheme was launched by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Culture
- [B] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [C] Ministry of Tourism
- [D] Ministry of Rural Development

Answer: Ministry of Tourism

Union Civil Aviation Minister said Centre plans to develop tourist areas around major temples in Andhra Pradesh under PRASHAD scheme. PRASHAD means Pilgrimage Rejuvenation and Spiritual Heritage Augmentation Drive. It was launched in 2014-2015 by the Ministry of Tourism. It is a Central Sector Scheme for integrated development of selected pilgrimage destinations. The objective is to improve tourism infrastructure at pilgrimage and heritage sites. Central Government gives 100% funding for approved public projects. States and Union Territories get financial assistance for infrastructure development. It also allows Corporate Social Responsibility and Public Private Partnership contributions

199. Vaan Island, that was recently seen in news, is located in which region?

- [A] Gulf of Mannar
- [B] Arabian Sea
- [C] Palk Strait
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Gulf of Mannar

A 10-year artificial reef project at Vaan Island created socio-ecological benefits worth ₹61.67 crore, more than double its inflation-adjusted cost. The study was done by the Tamil Nadu Coastal Restoration Mission and its partners. Vaan Island is located in the Gulf of Mannar. It is part of the Tuticorin group of islands in Tamil Nadu. The island faced severe coastal erosion and shrinking land area.

200. National Organ and Tissue Transplant Organization (NOTTO) works under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [B] Ministry of Social Justice
- [C] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [D] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Answer: Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

India achieved a major milestone in organ donation through the National Organ and Tissue Transplant Organization. It works under the Directorate General of Health Services, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, New Delhi. It was established under the Transplantation of Human Organs and Tissues (Amendment) Act, 2011. It has two divisions: National Human Organ and Tissue Removal and Storage Network, and National Biomaterial Centre. It is the apex body for coordination, organ allocation, and national



registry. It frames policy guidelines and protocols. It compiles and publishes national transplant data.

201. Suav River, that was recently seen in news, is a tributary of which river?

- [A] Narmada River
- [B] Rapti River
- [C] Cauvery River
- [D] Chenab River

Answer: Rapti River

The National Green Tribunal directed the Uttar Pradesh government to restore Suav's status from "drain" to "river" in official records. Suav is a major tributary of the Rapti River. Rapti is the most important left bank tributary of the Ghaghara River. Historically, Rapti was known as Iravati. It originates near Rukumkot in Nepal in the Mahabharat Range of the Lesser Himalayas.

202. Which state is home to India's largest integrated lithium-ion battery gigafactory?

- [A] Rajasthan
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Andhra Pradesh
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

Waaree Energies will set up India's largest lithium-ion battery gigafactory at Rambilli, Anakapalli district, Andhra Pradesh. Total investment is ₹8,175 crore for a greenfield project. The plant will have 16 Gigawatt-hour (GWh) capacity. It will cover full battery value chain: cell manufacturing, battery packs and Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS). It received in-principle approval from State Investment Promotion Board. The project supports clean-energy goals of Andhra Pradesh.

203. India's first comprehensive National Counter-Terrorism Policy titled 'PRAHAAR' was launched by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Defence
- [B] Ministry of External Affairs
- [C] Ministry of Law and Justice
- [D] Ministry of Home Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Home Affairs

Ministry of Home Affairs launched India's first National Counter-Terrorism Policy 'PRAHAAR'. PRAHAAR means "strike" and follows zero-tolerance against terrorism. It addresses cross-border terrorism, drone attacks, cyber threats and organised terror networks. It rejects linking terrorism with any religion or ethnicity. It is built on seven pillars: prevention, swift response, capacity-building, human rights compliance, anti-radicalisation, global cooperation and societal resilience.

204. Which state government launched 'Meri Rasoi Yojana' to strengthen food and nutrition security in February 2026?

- [A] Punjab



- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Haryana
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Punjab

Punjab government launched 'Meri Rasoi Yojana' to strengthen food and nutrition security. About 40 lakh families will receive free quarterly ration kits starting from April. The scheme supplements wheat provided under the National Food Security Act (NFSA). Each kit contains 2 kg moong-chana dal, 2 kg sugar, 1 kg iodized salt, 200 g turmeric powder and 1 litre mustard oil. Aim is to ensure balanced nutrition for economically weaker sections, poor and Dalit families.

205. Kole Wetland, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state?

- [A] Tamil Nadu
- [B] West Bengal
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Kerala

A recent study at Kole Wetlands recorded 12 species of pygmy grasshoppers. It is located in Kerala and is a Ramsar site since 2002. The name 'Kole' means "bumper crop" in Malayalam due to high productivity. It is one of the largest, most productive and threatened wetlands in Kerala. The area is low-lying with a narrow central strip and cultivated pockets. It faces seasonal saltwater ingress and monsoon submergence.

206. What is the name of the recent initiative launched to demolish memorials associated with Naxal ideology?

- [A] Operation Clean Sweep
- [B] Operation Demolishment
- [C] Operation Red Shield
- [D] Operation Prahaar

Answer: Operation Demolishment

India intensified action against Left-Wing Extremism (LWE) through "Operation Demolishment". The drive targets memorials and monuments linked to Naxal ideology. Aim is to weaken ideological influence and prevent youth recruitment. Total 203 memorials demolished in Maharashtra and Chhattisgarh. In Chhattisgarh, 149 structures removed from 2023–2026, with 130 in 2026 alone. In Maharashtra, 55 structures removed, including 45 in 2026. Memorials were used to glorify slain cadres and hold events. Operation is part of broader counterinsurgency strategy. Focus is on dismantling both armed network and ideological support base.

207. Where state is the host of National Arogya Fair 2026?

- [A] Odisha
- [B] Rajasthan
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Gujarat

**Answer: Maharashtra**

Ministry of Ayush with All India Ayurvedic Congress is organising National Arogya Fair 2026 at Shegaon, Buldhana, Maharashtra from 25–28 February 2026. The objective is to promote Ayush systems and provide free health check-ups, consultations and medicines. It covers Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Sowa Rigpa and Homoeopathy. The focus on farmers through medicinal plant cultivation and agroforestry.

208. The National SC-ST Hub–Mega Awareness Programme was organized by which ministry at Itanagar, Arunachal Pradesh?

- [A] Ministry of Tribal Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Commerce & Industry
- [C] Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
- [D] Ministry of Finance

Answer: Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises organised National SC-ST Hub Mega Awareness Programme on 23 February 2026 at Itanagar, Arunachal Pradesh. Aim was to promote entrepreneurship and awareness about National SC-ST Hub Scheme and other MSME schemes. 4% public procurement mandated for SC-ST owned Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) and 3% for Women MSEs. MSME sector is second largest employer after agriculture and contributes over 30% to Gross Domestic Product (GDP). Entrepreneurs received Udyam Registration support.

209. Which ministry launched Teacher App 2.0 – Powered by Artificial Intelligence (AI)?

- [A] Ministry of Electronics & IT
- [B] Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship
- [C] Ministry of Education
- [D] Ministry of Communication

Answer: Ministry of Education

Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan launched Teacher App 2.0 – Powered by Artificial Intelligence (AI) in New Delhi. It was developed in collaboration with Bharti Airtel and CK-12 Foundation. App acts as an AI-driven tech companion for schoolteachers. It provides digital tools, teaching content and performance dashboards. It supports integration of AI in education system. The focus on improving learning outcomes and personalised education.

210. Which tennis player won the Delhi Open 2026 men's singles title?

- [A] Siddhant Banthia
- [B] Oliver Crawford
- [C] Somdev Devvarman
- [D] Stefanos Sakellaridis

Answer: Stefanos Sakellaridis

In tennis, Stefanos Sakellaridis won the Delhi Open 2026 men's singles title. He defeated Oliver Crawford in the final with a 7-5, 5-6, 7-6 score. The 21-year-old secured his maiden Association of Tennis Professionals (ATP) Challenger Tour singles title. He won the



deciding tie-break 8-6 on his second match point. In doubles, Siddhant Banthia and Alexander Donski won the title. They defeated Niki Kaliyanda Poonacha and Pruchya Isaro in the final.

211. What is 'Contarinia icardiflores' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Fungal disease
- [B] Newly discovered species of Frog
- [C] Traditional medicine
- [D] Newly discovered species of blossom midge

Answer: Newly discovered species of blossom midge

Scientists from the ICAR-Directorate of Floricultural Research have discovered a new species of blossom midge named *Contarinia icardiflores*. *Contarinia icardiflores* is a newly identified species belonging to the genus *Contarinia*, whose members are small insects recognized as serious pests of ornamental and food crops worldwide. The larvae of this species feed inside flower buds or blossoms, often leading to severe yield losses in agricultural and horticultural crops. The species has been named in honour of ICAR-DFR to acknowledge the institute's significant contributions to floriculture research.

212. Which state government has introduced the 'Mahila Khushhali Yojna' for women farmers?

- [A] Rajasthan
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Jharkhand
- [D] Bihar

Answer: Jharkhand

The Jharkhand government has introduced the 'Mahila Khushhali Yojna' for women farmers, as announced in its 2026-27 state budget presented on February 24, 2026. The scheme aims to empower women in agriculture by providing support for modern techniques and marketing platforms, with an initial allocation of ₹25 crore. The scheme focuses on enhancing the participation of women in the agricultural sector, offering improved access to modern techniques, and expanding cold storage-enabled cooperative marketing complexes.

213. Fishing cat, that was recently seen in news, is native to which region?

- [A] Australia
- [B] Europe
- [C] North America
- [D] South and Southeast Asia

Answer: South and Southeast Asia

The first scientific assessment of the Fishing cat has identified Kaziranga National Park and Kaziranga Tiger Reserve as strongholds of this small wild feline species. The fishing cat (*Prionailurus viverrinus*) is a medium-sized wild cat known for its strong association with wetlands. It inhabits a variety of wetland ecosystems, including mangrove forests, swamps, marshes, and floodplains. It is native to South and Southeast Asia and has a fragmented distribution across the region. In India, it is primarily found in the mangrove



forests of the Sundarbans, along the foothills of the Himalayas in the Ganga and Brahmaputra river valleys, and in parts of the Western Ghats.

214. Which Manipuri film won the 79th BAFTA Award 2026 for Best Children's & Family Film?

- [A] Ishanou
- [B] Laman Ama
- [C] Boong
- [D] Khoidouwa

Answer: Boong

The Manipuri film Boong, produced by Farhan Akhtar's Excel Entertainment, won the BAFTA Award for Best Children's & Family Film in London. The film was directed by debutant Lakshmipriya Devi, who made an emotional appeal for peace during her acceptance speech. She received the award from Paddington Bear, the lead character of Paddington The Musical. Producers Farhan Akhtar and Ritesh Sidhwani, along with assistant director Rahul Sharda, joined her on stage.

215. Exercise DHARMA GUARDIAN 2026 is conducted between India and which country?

- [A] Australia
- [B] Vietnam
- [C] China
- [D] Japan

Answer: Japan

The 7th edition of the joint military exercise DHARMA GUARDIAN between India and Japan has commenced at the Foreign Training Node, Chaubattia, in Uttarakhand. The exercise is being conducted from 24 February to 9 March 2026. The exercise is held alternately in India and Japan and serves as an important pillar of defence cooperation between the two countries. The primary objective of Exercise DHARMA GUARDIAN is to strengthen military collaboration and enhance joint operational capabilities in a semi-urban environment.

216. Which ministry organized 'Him-CONNECT' as part of the The Energy and Resources Institute's World Sustainable Development Summit (WSDS)?

- [A] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [B] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- [C] Ministry of Rural Development
- [D] Ministry of Jal Shakti

Answer: Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change is organising 'Him-CONNECT' from 25-27 February 2026 in New Delhi as part of the The Energy and Resources Institute's World Sustainable Development Summit (WSDS). Him-CONNECT is designed as a collaborative platform to connect researchers working in the Indian Himalayan Region (IHR) with start-ups, investors and policymakers to facilitate the scaling and on-ground application of research outcomes. The platform will showcase more than 24 technologies, prototypes, patents and pilot projects developed under the Ministry's National Mission on Himalayan Studies (NMHS).



217. Where was Tourism Leadership Summit-2026 held?

- [A] New Delhi
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Bengaluru
- [D] Hyderabad

Answer: New Delhi

Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan inaugurated the Tourism Leadership Summit-2026 organised by the U.S.-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF) in New Delhi. Tourism is more than an industry, describing it as a bridge between cultures and a driver of economic opportunities. Tourism serves as a powerful instrument of soft diplomacy and acts as a key pillar of the India-US economic corridor. India has unveiled the Tourism Vision 2029, which aims to develop at least one world-class tourist destination in every state with robust infrastructure, seamless connectivity, smart amenities and sustainable practices.

218. Tennis player Tomas Martin Etcheverry, who recently won the Rio Open (ATP 500) title, belongs to which country?

- [A] Argentina
- [B] Chile
- [C] Brazil
- [D] Germany

Answer: Argentina

Argentine tennis player Tomas Martin Etcheverry won his maiden ATP Tour title by clinching the Rio Open (ATP 500) title in Brazil. He defeated Chile's Alejandro Tabilo in the final with a scoreline of 3-6, 7-6(3), 6-4 to secure the biggest title of his career. This triumph marked Etcheverry's first ATP crown after finishing runner-up in three previous tour-level finals. During the tournament, he also achieved a milestone by recording his 100th tour-level match win.

219. Recently, which country's Department of Energy eliminated the ALARA philosophy from its directives and regulations?

- [A] United Kingdom
- [B] France
- [C] United States
- [D] Japan

Answer: United States

The United States Department of Energy has removed the ALARA (As Low As Reasonably Achievable) philosophy from its directives and regulations, marking a significant shift from long-standing international radiation protection practices. For decades, the global radiation protection framework has been based on the Linear No-Threshold (LNT) model and the ALARA principle as its conceptual and operational foundations. The LNT model is a risk assessment framework which states that any amount of ionising radiation, no matter how small, carries some risk of causing harm, particularly cancer.



220. CM-302 is a supersonic anti-ship cruise missile developed by which country?

- [A] China
- [B] Russia
- [C] Germany
- [D] India

Answer: China

Reports indicate that Iran is close to finalising a defence deal with China to procure CM-302 supersonic anti-ship missiles to strengthen its naval strike capability. The CM-302 is a supersonic anti-ship cruise missile developed by China and is the export variant of the YJ-12 missile deployed by the Chinese Navy. The missile is specifically designed to target and destroy large naval vessels and other high-value maritime assets. It is powered by a liquid direct-flow air-breathing jet engine with four air intakes, enabling sustained high-speed flight. The missile can travel at speeds of around Mach 2.5 to Mach 3, making it extremely difficult for enemy air defence systems to intercept.

221. Which state government has recently re-implemented the Bhavantar Bhugtan Yojana (Price Difference Scheme) for the 2025-26 season?

- [A] Madhya Pradesh
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Uttarakhand

Answer: Madhya Pradesh

The Madhya Pradesh government, under Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, has recently re-implemented the Bhavantar Bhugtan Yojana (Price Difference Scheme) for the 2025-26 season to protect farmers from falling market prices. The government is extending this scheme to mustard and offering bonuses for urad, aiming to cover price deficits below the Minimum Support Price (MSP). The scheme was reintroduced in September 2025 for soybean and is being expanded in early 2026 to help farmers manage lower market rates.

222. The "Women, Business and the Law 2026" report was released by which organization?

- [A] International Monetary Fund
- [B] World Bank
- [C] World Economic Forum
- [D] United Nations Development Programme

Answer: World Bank

The World Bank released the Women, Business and the Law 2026 report highlighting a major gap between laws for women's equality and their real implementation. The Women, Business and the Law 2026 report is the 11th annual study covering 190 economies and uses the Women, Business and the Law 2.0 framework. It evaluates three pillars: Legal Frameworks, Supportive Frameworks, and Enforcement Perceptions. The global average score is 67.9 for legal frameworks, but only 47.3 for supportive systems and 53.4 for enforcement. Safety is the weakest area, with enforcement failing nearly 80 percent of the time and only one-third required safety laws in place.



223. Where was Pusa Krishi Vigyan Mela 2026 organized?

- [A] New Delhi
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Bengaluru

Answer: New Delhi

Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan inaugurated the three-day Pusa Krishi Vigyan Mela at Indian Agricultural Research Institute campus, New Delhi, promoting 'Viksit Krishi – Atmanirbhar Bharat'. The event was organised by Indian Council of Agricultural Research and attended by scientists, officials and progressive farmers. Krishi Vigyan Kendras will be strengthened as district-level reform centres to connect research with villages.

224. The Karnataka Bharat Gaurav Train operates under which policy of Indian Railways?

- [A] PRASHAD Scheme
- [B] Bharat Gaurav Policy
- [C] Dekho Apna Desh Scheme
- [D] Swadesh Darshan Scheme

Answer: Bharat Gaurav Policy

Union Minister of State V. Somanna launched the coffee table book "Karnataka Bharat Gaurav Train: Journey of a Thousand Shrines" at Rail Bhawan on 23 February 2026. The book highlights the Karnataka Bharat Gaurav Train as a major cultural and spiritual tourism initiative of Indian Railways. The initiative was conceptualised by Dr. Anup Dayanand, Indian Railway Traffic Service (Retired). The Karnataka Bharat Gaurav Train is a flagship pilgrimage tourism initiative launched under the Bharat Gaurav Policy of Indian Railways. The initiative transforms Indian Railways from being only a transport provider into a promoter of tourism, culture and spiritual connectivity.

225. The RAJMARG PRAVESH portal has been developed by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Rural Development
- [C] Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- [D] Ministry of Road Transport and Highways

Answer: Ministry of Road Transport and Highways

Union Minister Nitin Gadkari launched the upgraded RAJMARG PRAVESH web portal to simplify issuance of No Objection Certificates for facilities along National Highways. The portal has been developed by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways to improve transparency, speed and ease of doing business. It enables online applications for access permissions for fuel stations, wayside amenities, private properties, rest areas and connecting roads. Government and private entities can also seek approval for laying utilities like water pipelines, gas pipelines, optical fibre cables and electric lines along or across highways.

226. The Mobile Passport Seva Van is a citizen-centric, doorstep initiative launched by which ministry?



- [A] Ministry of External Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [C] Ministry of Finance
- [D] Ministry of Science and Technology

Answer: Ministry of External Affairs

The process of obtaining passports has been made easier for residents of Kutch district in Gujarat. The Regional Passport Office Ahmedabad launched a three-day Mobile Passport Van service in Bhuj from 25 February. The Mobile Passport Seva Van is a citizen-centric, doorstep initiative launched by the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), Government of India, aimed at improving last-mile delivery of passport services. It is specifically designed to assist residents in rural, remote, and underserved areas where Passport Seva Kendras (PSKs) are not readily available, allowing them to apply for fresh or renewed passports without traveling to distant cities

227. Where was North East Spring Festival 2026 held?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Tripura
- [C] Nagaland
- [D] Mizoram

Answer: Nagaland

The North East Spring Festival 2026, also known as the Festival of the North East, is inaugurated at the NEZCC Complex in Dimapur, Nagaland. The festival is organised by the North East Zone Cultural Centre in collaboration with the South-Central Zone Cultural Centre under the Ministry of Culture, Government of India. It is celebrated alongside Madhya Dakshini Festival 2026, creating cultural exchange between Northeastern and South-Central regions. The event promotes and preserves folk and tribal heritage and strengthens national integration. Around 130 folk artistes from eight Northeastern states present traditional art forms.

228. 'Kalari Leap' is a joint maritime exercise conducted in which state/UT?

- [A] Lakshadweep
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Andaman and Nicobar
- [D] Jammu and Kashmir

Answer: Lakshadweep

The Southern Air Command conducts a high-tempo joint maritime exercise named Kalari Leap in the Lakshadweep and Minicoy archipelago. The exercise validates joint planning, rapid force projection and precise operations in complex maritime environments. The Armed Forces Special Operations Division and the Indian Coast Guard participate in the joint drill. Indian Air Force assets operate alongside Coast Guard ships, Gemini boats and Dornier 228 aircraft. The exercise demonstrates readiness for integrated air, maritime and special operations in island territories.

229. Operation Trashi is a counter-terrorism operation conducted in which State/Union Territory?



- [A] Jammu and Kashmir
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Punjab

Answer: Jammu and Kashmir

In Jammu and Kashmir, Northern Command GOC-in-C Lieutenant General Pratik Sharma visits Kishtwar and praises troops for successful Operation Trashi. Three terrorists, including Jaish-e-Mohammad commander Saifullah, are killed in an encounter in Kishtwar district. Operation Trashi is a high-intensity counter-terrorism operation initiated in Jammu and Kashmir. It is carried out in a remote area with swift and precise coordination by security forces.

230. Which ministry launched the Blockchain India Challenge to promote permissioned blockchain solutions for digital governance?

- [A] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [B] Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- [C] Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- [D] Ministry of Corporate Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology launches the Blockchain India Challenge to promote permissioned blockchain solutions for digital governance. The initiative is implemented by the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing with support from MeitY. It aims to develop secure, tamper-proof and auditable blockchain systems to improve transparency and efficiency in government services.

231. Jeju Island, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Vietnam
- [B] South Korea
- [C] China
- [D] Japan

Answer: South Korea

The Embassy of India in Seoul issues an advisory for Indian nationals travelling to Jeju Island under the visa waiver scheme. Jeju Island is a volcanic island located off the southern coast of South Korea. It is designated as a special autonomous province of South Korea. The island is oval in shape and is the largest as well as the southernmost island of the country. Its provincial capital is Jeju City. The island is formed from volcanic material that rises symmetrically to the summit of Mount Hallasan.

232. Which four Indian States have been selected under the United Nations' road safety financing framework project?

- [A] Bihar, Jharkhand, Gujarat and Assam
- [B] Rajasthan, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Assam
- [C] Odisha, Uttarakhand, Madhya Pradesh and Mizoram
- [D] Maharashtra, Punjab, Odisha and Karnataka

**Answer: Rajasthan, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Assam**

The United Nations launches a project in partnership with four Indian states to develop a road safety financing framework. The initiative is being implemented in Rajasthan, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Assam under the coordination of the UN Resident Coordinator's Office in India. The project focuses on strengthening institutional capacity for effective implementation of road safety action plans. It aims to reduce road fatalities and serious injuries through better planning, funding and monitoring mechanisms.

233. What is 'Impatiens nagorum' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] A new flowering plant species
- [B] Invasive weed
- [C] Traditional medicine
- [D] Newly discovered species of Fish

Answer: A new flowering plant species

Botanists discovered a new flowering plant species named *Impatiens nagorum* from Northeast India. It was found in Fakim Wildlife Sanctuary in Nagaland. The name "nagorum" honours the Naga tribes of the state. *Impatiens*, commonly called balsams or "touch-me-nots," are known for bright flowers and seed pods that burst when touched. The Eastern Himalayas and Northeast India are global hotspots for this plant group. It grows in moist temperate broadleaf forests and is known only from its original discovery site. It has purple flowers, serrated leaves, slightly hairy lateral sepals, and a deep lower sepal forming a hooked spur.

234. Mai Ndombe and Tumba lakes, that were recently seen in news, are located in which country?

- [A] Democratic Republic of Congo
- [B] Kenya
- [C] Indonesia
- [D] Russia

Answer: Democratic Republic of Congo

Researchers found that Mai Ndombe and Tumba lakes in the Democratic Republic of Congo are releasing carbon stored for thousands of years in surrounding peatlands. Peatlands are terrestrial wetland ecosystems with waterlogged conditions that prevent full decomposition of plant material. Lake Mai Ndombe is Africa's largest blackwater lake, part of the Congo River Basin, located in western Democratic Republic of Congo. Lake Tumba is located in northwestern Democratic Republic of Congo.

235. Where was Exercise Agni Varsha 2026 conducted by the Indian Army?

- [A] Punjab
- [B] Rajasthan
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Jammu and Kashmir

Answer: Rajasthan

The Integrated Fire and Manoeuvre Exercise Agni Varsha was conducted at Pokhran Field Firing Range, Jaisalmer, Rajasthan, by the Southern Command of the Indian Army. The



exercise highlighted combat effectiveness of mechanised forces operating across multiple domains. Foreign defence journalists from 25 countries witnessed the exercise, observing speed, accuracy, and synchronisation of Combined Arms formations in the Thar Desert. Agni Varsha incorporated modern battlefield technologies: unmanned aerial systems, counter-drone measures, precision strike rockets, artillery platforms, and networked surveillance assets.

236. What is "Staphylococcus aureus" that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Virus
- [B] Bacteria
- [C] Fungus
- [D] Protozoa

Answer: Bacteria

An institute of the Department of Science and Technology (DST) in North East India has synthesised a novel biosurfactant effective against the bacterium *Staphylococcus aureus*. *Staphylococcus aureus* is a Gram-positive, non-motile, round-shaped bacterium from the family *Staphylococcaceae*. It occurs in grape-like clusters and is commonly found in the environment. It affects all mammalian species, including humans, and can be transmitted between species. Transmission occurs through air droplets, direct contact with contaminated objects, or bites from infected persons or animals. It causes minor skin infections, boils, cellulitis, abscesses, scalded skin syndrome, and may lead to pneumonia.

237. Which state government launched "Operation Crackdown" to dismantle organised cybercrime networks and curb financial fraud?

- [A] Telangana
- [B] Uttar Pradesh
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Rajasthan

Answer: Telangana

Telangana Police launched "Operation Crackdown", a special statewide drive to dismantle organised cybercrime networks and curb financial fraud. The operation is led by the Telangana Cyber Security Bureau (TGCSB) in coordination with district police units and commissionerates, to be conducted in phases over coming months. The first phase targeted mule bank accounts across 16 districts, used to route proceeds of cyber fraud. Telangana Cyber Security Bureau (TGCSB) data revealed 4,775 mule accounts in 2025; 1,888 accounts across 137 bank branches were verified.

238. Which organization released the Global Mind Health 2025 report?

- [A] World Health Organization (WHO)
- [B] Sapien Labs
- [C] United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)
- [D] National Alliance on Mental Illness (NAMI)

Answer: Sapien Labs

Sapien Labs, a not-for-profit organization, released the Global Mind Health 2025 report



under its Global Mind Project. The report is based on Mind Health Quotient (MHQ), covering mental, emotional, cognitive, social functions, drive, and resilience. In India, young adults (18–34) have an MHQ score of 33 (global average 66), ranking 60th globally in mental health and well-being. Indians aged 55 plus score 96, ranking 49th globally. 44% of 18–34-year-olds consume ultra-processed foods, linked to increased depression and reduced emotional and cognitive control.

239. What is the IUCN conservation status of Smew (small diving duck) that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Vulnerable
- [B] Near Threatened
- [C] Endangered
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Least Concern

The Smew was recently sighted for the first time in Kaziranga during the 7th Waterbird Count at Rowmari-Donduwa beels (Laokhowa) buffer of Kaziranga Tiger Reserve. Smew is a small diving duck. They breeds in the northern taiga of Europe and the Palearctic region. They requires trees for breeding and prefers fish-rich lakes and slow rivers. The conservation status of Smew according to the IUCN Red List is Least Concern.

240. What is the name of the policy recently launched by Indian Railways to systematically induct technology and innovation?

- [A] RailVision Policy
- [B] RailTech Policy
- [C] RailInnovate Policy
- [D] RailDigital Policy

Answer: RailTech Policy

Ashwini Vaishnaw, Union Minister for Railways, Information & Broadcasting, and Electronics & IT, announced the RailTech Policy and complete digitisation of the Railway Claims Tribunal (RCT). These are the third and fourth reforms under Indian Railways' "52 Reforms in 52 Weeks" initiative. RailTech Policy aims to bring technology and innovation into Railways via startups, industry, and research institutions through a transparent framework. A dedicated RailTech Portal will allow innovators to submit proposals digitally; scale-up grants tripled, prototype grants doubled.

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